

DO NOT OPEN THIS TEST BOOKLET UNTIL YOU ARE ASKED TO DO SO**TEST BOOKLET SERIES****Test Code:
2204****TEST BOOKLET
GENERAL STUDIES
TEST – 4****D****Time Allowed : Two Hours****Maximum Marks : 200****INSTRUCTIONS**

1. IMMEDIATELY AFTER THE COMMENCEMENT OF THE EXAMINATION, YOU SHOULD CHECK THAT THIS TEST BOOKLET *DOES NOT* HAVE ANY UNPRINTED OR TORN OR MISSING PAGES OR ITEMS, ETC. IF SO, GET IT REPLACED BY A COMPLETE TEST BOOKLET.
2. ENCODE CLEARLY THE TEST BOOKLET SERIES CODE **A, B, C** OR **D** AS THE CASE MAY BE IN THE APPROPRIATE PLACE IN THE ANSWER SHEET.
3. You have to enter your Roll Number on the Test Booklet in the Box provided alongside this line. *DO NOT* write *anything else* on the Test Booklet.
4. This Test Booklet contains 100 items (questions). Each question is printed both in **Hindi** and **English**. Each item comprises four responses (answers). You will select the response which you want to mark on the Answer Sheet. In case you feel that there is more than one correct response, mark the response which you consider the best. In any case, choose **ONLY ONE** response for each item.
5. You have to mark all your responses **ONLY** on the separate Answer Sheet provided. See directions in the Answer sheet.
6. All items carry equal marks.
7. Before you proceed to mark in the Answer Sheet the response to various items in the Test Booklet, you have to fill in some particulars in the Answer Sheet as per instructions sent to you with your admission certificate.
8. After you have completed filling in all your responses on the Answer Sheet and examination has concluded, you should hand over to the Invigilator *only the Answer Sheet*. You are permitted to take away with you the Test Booklet.
9. Sheets for rough work are appended in the Test Booklet at the end.
10. **Penalty for wrong answers:**
THERE WILL BE PENALTY FOR WRONG ANSWERS MARKED BY A CANDIDATE IN THE OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTION PAPERS.
 - (i) There are four alternatives for the answer to every question. For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, **One-Third** of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty.
 - (ii) If a candidate gives more than one answer, it will be treated as a **wrong answer** even if one of the given answers happens to be correct and there will be same penalty as above to that question.
 - (iii) If a question is left blank, i.e., no answer is given by the candidate, there will be no **penalty** for that question.

DO NOT OPEN THIS TEST BOOKLET UNTIL YOU ARE ASKED TO DO SO*Note:* Hindi version of the instructions is printed on the front cover of this Booklet.



1. Consider the following statements:

1. Abolishing Industrial licensing for all industries.
2. Establishment of Private Banks.
3. Reduction of export duties to promote exports.

Which of the above were a part of policy changes in Economic Reforms of 1991?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

2. Regarding the Smart Cities Mission, consider the following statements:

1. Major part of the fund used for Smart Cities Mission is contributed by Public Private Partnerships.
2. Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs is the nodal Ministry for this scheme.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

3. Which of the following countries share its border with the Red Sea?

1. Saudi Arabia 2. Yemen
3. Israel 4. Egypt
5. Syria

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 5 only (b) 2 and 4 only
(c) 1, 2 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 4 and 5 only

4. A surge in the investment by Sovereign Wealth Funds in India has been noticed recently. Which of the following are the likely causes behind this trend?

1. Rapid rise of an educated middle class
2. Positive demographics
3. Regulatory reforms
4. Expanding infrastructure

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 1, 2 and 4 only
(c) 2, 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

5. Consider the following statements regarding 'Disk-footed bat':

1. It is a type of flying mammal.
2. It comes under the "Least Concern" category of IUCN Red List Status.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

6. Consider the following statements about India-US Bilateral Trade:

1. India has a trade surplus with the USA.
2. India is the largest service exporter to the USA.
3. India is not a beneficiary of the duty-free benefits provided under the US Generalised System of Preferences.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

7. Consider the following statements regarding World Trade Organisations' (WTO) Dispute Settlement mechanisms:

1. WTO has a two-stage dispute settlement system.
2. The decisions of the WTO Appellate body are final and sanctions can be imposed on a member in case of its failure to comply with the Appellate Body's rulings.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

8. Consider the following statements regarding the Anamaya initiative:

1. The beneficiaries under the initiative are the rural as well as the urban population of India.
2. It was launched by the Ministry of Rural Development.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2



641, प्रथम तल, मुखर्जी
नगर, दिल्ली-110009

21, पूसा रोड, करोल
बाग, नई दिल्ली

13/15, ताशकंद मार्ग, निकट पत्रिका
चौराहा, सिविल लाइन्स, प्रयागराज

प्लॉट नंबर-45 व 45-A हर्ष टावर-2,
मेन टॉक रोड, वसुंधरा कॉलोनी, जयपुर

3

दूरभाष : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com



9. Which of the following best describes Extended Fund Facility (EFF)?
- It is an IMF's assistance to a country in case of structural weaknesses.
 - It is an international reserve asset, created by the IMF to supplement its member countries' official reserves.
 - It is a loan facility extended by World bank.
 - None of these
10. The terms 'Event Horizon', 'Singularity', 'String Theory' and 'Standard Model' are sometimes seen in the news in the context of
- Observation and understanding of the Universe.
 - Nuclear reactors
 - Gene Therapy to tackle the spread of Covid-19.
 - Origin and evolution of living organisms on the Earth.
11. The term 'Talanoa Dialogue' is sometimes seen in news with reference to
- Facilitative dialogue for taking stock on progress towards long term goals stated in Paris Agreement.
 - Facilitative dialogue to break deadlock in World Trade Organisation negotiations.
 - Facilitative dialogue to deal with the problem of illegal trafficking of endangered species.
 - Facilitative dialogue to build consensus in Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership.
12. With reference to EASE (Enhanced Access and Service Excellence) Reforms, consider the following statements:
- It aims to institutionalize smart banking.
 - EASE was recommended by the PJ Nayak committee of the RBI on responsible banking.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- 1 only
 - 2 only
 - Both 1 and 2
 - Neither 1 nor 2
13. With reference to Central Electricity Regulatory Commission, consider the following statements:
- Indian Energy Exchange is approved and regulated by Central Electricity Regulatory Commission (CERC).
 - Central Electricity Regulatory Commission (CERC) intends to promote competition, efficiency and economy in bulk power markets.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- 1 only
 - 2 only
 - Both 1 and 2
 - Neither 1 nor 2
14. With reference to PPP models, consider the following statements:
- In the Hybrid Annuity Model, the central government bears 60% of the project cost.
 - Under the Engineering, Procurement, and Construction model, the cost is completely borne by the government.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- 1 only
 - 2 only
 - Both 1 and 2
 - Neither 1 nor 2
15. Consider the following statements regarding the Aditya-L1 Mission:
- Aditya-L1 is the first-ever mission of India to study the Sun.
 - It will be placed in the halo orbit around the Lagrange point.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- 1 only
 - 2 only
 - Both 1 and 2
 - Neither 1 nor 2
16. With reference to 'National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources', consider the following statements:
- It was started in response to the realization of perceived effects of the Green Revolution on agrobiodiversity.
 - It helps in crop improvement and diversification through germplasm introduction from various foreign countries.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- 1 only
 - 2 only
 - Both 1 and 2
 - Neither 1 nor 2





17. Consider the following statements about PM SVANidhi:
1. Urban Local Bodies have an important role to play in the implementation of this scheme.
 2. This scheme is aimed at Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs).
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
18. Consider the following Countries:
1. Bangladesh
 2. Bhutan
 3. India
 4. Indonesia
 5. Afghanistan
 6. China
- Which of the above are the members of the E-9 Partnership for Education?
- (a) 2, 3 and 5 only
(b) 1, 4 and 5 only
(c) 1, 3, 4 and 6 only
(d) 2, 3, 4 and 6 only
19. Which of the following are the objectives of Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights (PPV & FR) Act, 2001?
1. A farmer can save, use, sow and sell but cannot share his farm produce including seed of a variety protected under the PPV&FR Act, 2001.
 2. This Act also facilitates the growth of seed industry for indigeneous availability of advanced quality products.
- Select the correct answer using the code given below:
- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2
20. Recently the "RESPOND" Program was in the news. It is related to
- (a) Air Traffic Control
 - (b) Indian Space Research Organization
 - (c) WHO program to eliminate COVID-19
 - (d) None of the above
21. Consider the following statements about the estimates of Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) for productive age group:
1. The rate of decline of female LFPR was sharper in rural areas as compared to urban areas.
 2. Female LFPR is higher in rural areas as compared to urban areas.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
22. With reference to the institutions of the World Bank group, consider the following statements:
1. The International Finance Corporation (IFC) provides loans, equity, and advisory services to stimulate private sector investment in developing countries.
 2. Governments of middle-income and creditworthy low-income countries are provided lending facilities by the International Development Association (IDA).
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
23. Consider the following statements regarding the Sagarmala Project?
1. The Union Ministry of Shipping is the nodal ministry for this initiative.
 2. It aims to develop a string of ports around India's coast.
 3. It does not include the establishment of rail/road linkages with the port terminals.
- Which of the statements given above are correct?
- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3





24. With reference to “National Education Policy (NEP), 2020”, consider the following statements:

1. It will bring the uncovered age group of 3-6 years under school curriculum.
2. Teaching up to at least Grade 5 to be in mother tongue/regional language.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

25. Consider the following statements regarding Boao Forum for Asia (BFA):

1. Boao Forum for Asia (BFA) is a “Not for Profit” Organization.
2. India is not a member of BFA.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

26. Which among the following are components under under Pradhan Mantri Kisan Sampada Yojna (PMKSY)?

1. Mega Food Parks
2. National Agriculture Market (eNAM)
3. Food Quality Assurance Infrastructure
4. Creation of Backward and Forward Linkages.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 1, 2 and 4 only
(c) 2, 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 3 and 4 only

27. With reference to Multilateral Development Banks, consider the following statements:

1. Asia Infrastructure and Investment Bank (AIIB) has invested in metro-rail projects in various cities in India giving a boost to the Smart City initiative.
2. The USA is among the largest shareholders in the Asian Development Bank.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

28. Recently, seen in the news ‘Shaphari’ is

- (a) a certification scheme for food grains
- (b) a certification scheme for aquaculture products
- (c) a certification program for trans fat elimination
- (d) a certification program for both aquaculture and food grains

29. Which of the following is/are the provision of The Farmers’ Produce Trade and Commerce (Promotion and Facilitation) Act, 2020?

1. The farmers will not be charged any cess or levy for sale of their produce and will not have to bear transport costs.
2. The act allows barrier-free inter-state and intra-state trade and commerce.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

30. Which of the following are **not** the end products of the process of coal gasification?

- (a) Hydrogen (b) Oxygen
- (c) Urea (d) Carbon Dioxide

31. With reference to IBSA Dialogue Forum, consider the following statements:

1. IBSA was founded in 2003 by Brasilia Declaration.
2. IBSA functions under the BRICS grouping.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

32. Consider the following statements:

1. India was the largest fish producer in the world in 2018-19.
2. In India, more than fifty percent of the fisheries production comes from inland fisheries.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2



641, प्रथम तल, मुखर्जी
नगर, दिल्ली-110009

21, पूसा रोड, करोल
बाग, नई दिल्ली

13/15, ताशकंद मार्ग, निकट पत्रिका
चौराहा, सिविल लाइन्स, प्रयागराज

प्लॉट नंबर-45 व 45-A हर्ष टावर-2,
मेन टॉक रोड, वसुंधरा कॉलोनी, जयपुर

9

दूरभाष : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com



33. With reference to the Marine Products Exports Development Authority, consider the following statements:
1. It is a state-owned agency engaged in fishery production and allied activities.
 2. It functions under the Union Ministry of Commerce and Industry.
 3. Its mandate is to increase exports and imports of seafood.
- Which of the statements given above are correct?
- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3
34. Which of the following ports is India's first trans-shipment hub?
- (a) Cochin Port
(b) Kandla Port
(c) Visakhapatnam Port
(d) New Mangalore Port
35. Consider the following statements regarding the disease 'Diabetes':
1. It is a communicable disease.
 2. "Global Diabetes Compact" is an initiative started by WHO that will help to fight against diabetes.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
36. Consider the following statements about Agricultural Census in India:
1. It is conducted every five years in India.
 2. Agricultural Census is carried out as a Central Sector Scheme under which 100% financial assistance is provided to States/Union Territories.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
37. With reference to the National Digital Health Mission (NDHM), consider the following statements:
1. NDHM aims to provide health ID to Indian citizens which will store an individual's medical records.
 2. It is mandatory for everyone to enroll in this initiative.
 3. The Bureau of Pharma Public Sector Undertakings of India has the mandate to design, build, roll-out and implement the NDHM.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 and 3 only
38. With reference to the Mahatma Jyotirao Phule, consider the following statements:
1. Chatrapati Shivajiraje Bhosle Yancha and Gulamgiri are among his major publications.
 2. He believed that the only solution to combat the social evils was the enlightenment of the lower castes women only.
 3. He worked for the abolishment of untouchability and the caste system in Maharashtra.
- Which of the statements given above are correct?
- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3
39. Consider the following statements:
1. LaQshya Programme is aimed at improving the quality of care in the labour room and maternity operation theatres in public health facilities.
 2. Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan (PMSMA) is a conditional cash transfer scheme for pregnant and lactating women.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2





40. "E-2025" initiative is related to which disease

- (a) Malaria (b) Tuberculosis
(c) Dengue (d) AIDS

41. Consider the following statements:

- Over 70% of handloom weavers and allied workers are women.
- The textiles and handloom sector in India is the second-largest source of employment to people, after agriculture.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

42. With reference to Mahila Samridhi Yojana, consider the following statements:

- The scheme is under the Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship.
- The scheme trains women belonging to the Minorities community in tailoring, knitting, embroidery and allied activities.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

43. With reference to the State of the Global Climate for 2020, consider the following statements:

- Concentrations of the major greenhouse gases in the air continued to increase in 2019 and 2020.
- Over 80% of the ocean area experienced at least one marine heatwave in 2020.
- It is released annually by the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP).

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 2 and 3 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

44. Consider the following statements about Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Janaushadhi Pariyojana (PMBJP):

- National Health Mission is the implementing agency of PMBJP.
- The objective of the scheme is to reduce the out of pocket expenditure in healthcare.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

45. Consider the following statements regarding the Integrated Health Information Platform (IHIP):

- It is the world's biggest disease surveillance program.
- The Union Ministry of Health & Family Welfare is its nodal ministry.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

46. Which of the following statements is/are **not** correct regarding the Draft Defence Production and Export Promotion Policy 2020?

- Its goal is to achieve a turnover of 10 lakh crore including export in Aerospace and Defence goods and services by 2025.
- The share of domestic procurement in overall Defence procurement should reach 60%.
- Focus areas include Support to startups and export promotion.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 3 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

47. Which of the following statements are correct?

- International Development Association (IDA) provides loans and grants to poor countries.
- Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA) seeks to encourage foreign direct investment in developing nations.
- The International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) provides financial assistance to middle-income and creditworthy low-income countries.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3



641, प्रथम तल, मुखर्जी
नगर, दिल्ली-110009

21, पूसा रोड, करोल
बाग, नई दिल्ली

13/15, ताशकंद मार्ग, निकट पत्रिका
चौराहा, सिविल लाइन्स, प्रयागराज

प्लॉट नंबर-45 व 45-A हर्ष टावर-2,
मेन टॉक रोड, वसुंधरा कॉलोनी, जयपुर

13

दूरभाष : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com



48. Consider the following statements regarding World Press Freedom Index 2021:
1. It is an indicator of the quality of journalism.
 2. Norway has topped for the fifth year in a row.
- Which of the statements given above is/are **not** correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
49. With reference to 'The Convention on Domestic Workers', consider the following statements:
1. The convention has been developed under the aegis of the World Trade Organization.
 2. India is signatory to the convention.
 3. The convention aims to set up labour standards for domestic workers.
- Which of the statements given above are correct?
- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3
50. Recently released 'SUPACE Portal' is related to
- (a) Judiciary (b) Police Stations
(c) State Governance (d) None of the above
51. Consider the following statements regarding Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-National Urban Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NULM) :
1. DAY-NULM is being implemented by Union Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs.
 2. It is a Central Sector Scheme.
 3. Recently, it has been conferred the prestigious SKOCH Governance Gold Award for its Portal for 'Affordable Credit and Interest Subvention Access' (PAiSA).
- Which of the statements given above are correct?
- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3
52. With reference to eSanjeevani Portal, consider the following statements:
1. eSanjeevani Portal is being implemented under the Ayushman Bharat-Health and Wellness Centre (AB-HWCs) programme.
 2. eSanjeevaniOPD is portal providing free of cost service enabling two-way interaction between doctor and patient and also generates a prescription slip.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
53. Which of the following is/are the eligibility conditions for startups to receive financial assistance under the Startup India Seed Fund Scheme?
1. A startup incorporated not more than 2 years ago at the time of application.
 2. Startups should not have received more than Rs. 10 lakh of monetary support under any other Central or State Government scheme.
- Select the correct answer using the codes given below:
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
54. With reference to the Land Reforms in India, consider the following statements:
1. The policy thrust of the second plan was rights to tenants to cultivate land and abolishing the intermediaries.
 2. Land ceiling means fixing the maximum size of land which could be owned by an individual.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2



641, प्रथम तल, मुखर्जी
नगर, दिल्ली-110009

21, पूसा रोड, करोल
बाग, नई दिल्ली

13/15, ताशकंद मार्ग, निकट पत्रिका
चौराहा, सिविल लाइन्स, प्रयागराज

प्लॉट नंबर-45 व 45-A हर्ष टावर-2,
मेन टॉक रोड, वसुंधरा कॉलोनी, जयपुर

15

दूरभाष : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com



55. Consider the following statements regarding 'Alkaloids' :

1. It is a naturally occurring psychologically active compound.
2. It is extracted from Opium gum.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

56. With reference to the 'Scheme for Adolescent Girls (SAG)', consider the following statements:

1. It is a central sector scheme.
2. The target group of the Scheme is girls in the age group of 11-18.
3. It is being implemented through the Anganwadi Centres (AWCs) under the Integrated Child Development Scheme (ICDS).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

57. With reference to the Right to Education Act, 2009, consider the following statements:

1. It provides for free elementary education, compulsory admission, to every child in the 6 to 14 age group.
2. It specifies the sharing of financial and other responsibilities between the Central and State Governments.
3. It provides for a specified pupil teacher ratio for each school ensuring that there is no urban-rural imbalance in teacher postings.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

58. Which of the following is/are correct regarding Brucellosis disease?

1. It is a viral disease, which mainly infects cattle, swine, goats, sheep and dogs.
2. Person to person transmission is rare.
3. There is no risk to humans due to this disease.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1 and 2 only

59. Consider the following statements about the Buffer Stocks:

1. The minimum buffer norms are fixed by the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs.
2. The buffer stock for pulses is maintained by the Department of Consumer Affairs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

60. Consider the following statements regarding 'Sankalp se Siddhi':

1. The major objective of this program is to activate and digitally connect the Van Dhan Vikas Kendras of the tribal villages.
2. It is launched by the Ministry of Electronics & Information Technology.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

61. Which of the following are the basic dimensions for the measurement of 'Human Development Index' (HDI)?

1. Gross National Income per capita
2. Life expectancy at birth
3. Mean years of education
4. Gender Inequality
5. Governance

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
(b) 1, 2, 3 and 4 only
(c) 2, 3, 4 and 5 only
(d) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5



641, प्रथम तल, मुखर्जी नगर, दिल्ली-110009

21, पूसा रोड, करोल बाग, नई दिल्ली

13/15, ताशकंद मार्ग, निकट पत्रिका चौराहा, सिविल लाइन्स, प्रयागराज

प्लॉट नंबर-45 व 45-A हर्ष टावर-2, मेन टॉक रोड, वसुंधरा कॉलोनी, जयपुर

17

दूरभाष : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com



62. Consider the following statements:

1. Headcount Ratio is the percent of the population that lives under the poverty line.
2. Misery Index is the sum of unemployment rate and inflation.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

63. Consider the following statements:

1. Snow Leopards are mainly found in central and southern Asia.
2. Project Snow Leopard (PSL) was launched to promote an inclusive and participatory approach to conserve snow leopards and their habitat.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

64. With reference to Insurance Ombudsman in India, consider the following statements:

1. It derives its powers from the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority Act, 1999.
2. He serves his office for the term of five years and is not eligible for reappointment.
3. His jurisdiction covers the deficiencies in service on the part of insurers, agents, brokers and other intermediaries.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

65. Consider the following statements with respect to the Trade Deficit :

1. The trade deficit is an indicator to show a negative balance of trade.
2. It forms a part of the Current Account Deficit (CAD).

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

66. Consider the following statements about Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB):

1. The membership in AIIB is open to all members of the World Bank.
2. The AIIB finances infrastructure in the countries of Asia only.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

67. Consider the following statements about Rural Infrastructure Development Fund (RIDF):

1. It provides low cost funds to State governments for rural infrastructure projects.
2. It has been set up within NABARD.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

68. Every year, April 22 is celebrated as Earth Day to raise public awareness about the environment and inspire people to save and protect it. The theme of Earth Day 2021 is

- (a) Climate Action
(b) Protect our species
(c) End Plastic Pollution
(d) Restore Our Earth

69. 'Blue Chip Stocks' refers to

- (a) Highly priced companies stock
(b) Low priced companies stock
(c) IPO's of any company
(d) Government securities



641, प्रथम तल, मुखर्जी
नगर, दिल्ली-110009

21, पूसा रोड, करोल
बाग, नई दिल्ली

13/15, ताशकंद मार्ग, निकट पत्रिका
चौराहा, सिविल लाइन्स, प्रयागराज

प्लॉट नंबर-45 व 45-A हर्ष टावर-2,
मेन टॉक रोड, वसुंधरा कॉलोनी, जयपुर

19

दूरभाष : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com



70. With reference to the 'Unique Land Parcel Identification Number'(ULPIN), consider the following statements:

1. The ULPIN is a 14-digit identification number given to every piece of land in the country.
2. It will be based on the latitudes and longitudes coordinates of the land parcel.
3. The scheme will only cover 10 states in India by March 2022.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

71. With reference to International Civil Aviation Organisation, consider the following statements:

1. It laid the foundation for the standards and procedures for peaceful global air navigation.
2. ICAO also approves world flight routes for international air traffic.
3. It was established by the Chicago Convention in 1944.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

72. Consider the following statements on the Code on Wages Act, 2019:

1. According to the Code, the central government will fix a single floor wage for the entire country to realize a basic standard of living for the workers.
2. The Code does not delve into the issue of gender pay gap.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

73. With reference to Civil Services Day, consider the following statements:

1. 21st April is celebrated as Civil Services Day by the Government of India.

2. On this day, the Prime Minister's Awards for Excellence in Public Administration are presented to States.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

74. With reference to Market Intervention Scheme (MIS), consider the following statements:

1. The basic idea behind this scheme is to provide remunerative prices to the farmers when the excess production leads to fall in general price.
2. Primarily, the non-perishable agricultural and horticultural commodities are covered under the scheme.
3. MIS is also known as the invisible hand of agricultural marketing.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

75. Consider the following statements about the 'Global Gender Gap Report 2021':

1. The report is released by the World Economic Forum (WEF).
2. The current rank of India is under 100 in Global Gender Gap Index.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

76. Consider the following statements regarding the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR):

1. ICAR has set up a Farmer Innovation Fund.
2. It was founded by Dr. M.S. Swaminathan.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2



641, प्रथम तल, मुखर्जी नगर, दिल्ली-110009

21, पूसा रोड, करोल बाग, नई दिल्ली

13/15, ताशकंद मार्ग, निकट पत्रिका चौराहा, सिविल लाइन्स, प्रयागराज

प्लॉट नंबर-45 व 45-A हर्ष टावर-2, मेन टॉक रोड, वसुंधरा कॉलोनी, जयपुर

21

दूरभाष : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com



77. Consider the following statements about Women Livelihood Bonds (WLBs):
1. Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI) acts as a financial intermediary for raising funds for women entrepreneurship.
 2. The WLBs will be listed on the stock exchanges.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
78. Consider the following statements regarding the Navegaon-Nagzira Tiger Reserve (NNTR):
1. It is located at the tri-junction of Karnataka, Maharashtra and Telangana.
 2. It is one of the oldest tiger reserves in Maharashtra.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
79. Consider the following statements with reference to 'Compulsory Licensing':
1. Compulsory Licensing in India is regulated under the Indian Patent Act, 1970.
 2. It is not permitted under the Trade Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS Agreement).
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
80. India's project for the development of motorable roads, 'Project Dantak', was recently in the news. It is being implemented in which neighbouring country?
- (a) Nepal
(b) Bhutan
(c) Bangladesh
(d) Myanmar
81. With reference to Agri-Market Infrastructure Fund (AMIF), consider the following statements:
1. The AMIF aims at setting up food processing and storage units.
 2. The fund has been created within NABARD.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
82. Under the Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN) programme, which of the following vulnerable landholding farming families will be provided direct income support?
1. Farming families who have small or marginal landholdings
 2. Farming families affected by natural calamities and/or farmer suicides
 3. Farming families who are landless
 4. Farming families who fall below the poverty line
- Select the correct answer using the code given below:
- (a) 1 only
(b) 1, 2 and 4 only
(c) 1, 3 and 4 only
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4
83. With reference to the National Supercomputing Mission (NSM), consider the following statements:
1. Under this mission, a grid of supercomputers will be established in educational and research institutions.
 2. The project is being implemented by the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC), Pune.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2





84. With reference to the Demography of India, consider the following statements:

1. Total Fertility Rate is now below replacement level fertility in most of the major states
2. The population in the 0-19 age bracket has already peaked.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

85. Which of the following statements regarding the National Minorities Commission is/are correct?

1. It is neither a constitutional nor a statutory body.
2. The chairperson must be a former judge of the supreme court and must belong to a minority community.
3. The commission has been given the power of a civil court while trying a suit.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 3 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

86. With reference to the Planetary-Pressure adjusted Human Development Index, consider the following statements:

1. It is HDI adjusted to the impact of challenges like COVID-19 pandemic.
2. India performs better in this Index compared to the Human Development Index.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

87. Which of the following group of subsidies is also known as 'Production-Neutral Box' in World Trade Organization (WTO)?

- (a) Amber Box
- (b) Red Box
- (c) Green Box
- (d) Blue Box

88. With reference to the Aahaar Kranti Mission, consider the following statements:

1. This mission is focused on increasing food grain production as well as spreading awareness about nutritional foods.
2. It is focused on a nutritionally balanced diet replete with locally sourced fruits and vegetables.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

89. With reference to the Mission Karmayogi, consider the following statements:

1. The scheme covers group A and group B officers in Central government only.
2. The Prime Minister's Public Human Resources (HR) Council has been set up under this mission.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

90. With reference to the Indian Rhino Vision 2020, consider the following statements:

1. One of its aims was to relocate rhinoceros to different parts of the country.
2. This programme was started in 2005 and will continue till 2025.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2



641, प्रथम तल, मुखर्जी
नगर, दिल्ली-110009

21, पूसा रोड, करोल
बाग, नई दिल्ली

13/15, ताशकंद मार्ग, निकट पत्रिका
चौराहा, सिविल लाइन्स, प्रयागराज

प्लॉट नंबर-45 व 45-A हर्ष टावर-2,
मेन टॉक रोड, वसुंधरा कॉलोनी, जयपुर

25

दूरभाष : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com



91. Which of the following have been identified as Domestic Systemically Important Insurers (D-SIIs) for 2020-21?

1. The Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC)
2. General Insurance Corporation of India
3. The New India Assurance Co Ltd

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

92. With reference to Kisan Credit Card (KCC) Scheme, consider the following statements:

1. KCC is implemented by commercial banks only.
2. KCC also covers post-harvest expenses.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

93. Which of the following statements is/are correct about 'Hedging'?

1. Hedging is a financial technique that helps to reduce risk from future change in value.
2. It is a kind of insurance that does not eliminate the risk completely but mitigates its effect.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

94. Which among the following are correct regarding Poshan Abhiyaan:

1. The National Council on Nutrition (NCN) has been set up under this.

2. The targeted group is young children and adolescent girls only.

3. The target of the mission is to bring down stunting among children in the age group 0-6 years from 38.4% to 25% by 2022.

4. Swasth Bharat Preraks are a part of this.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 only
(b) 1, 3 and 4 only
(c) 2, 3 and 4 only
(d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

95. With reference to the mRNA Vaccines, consider the following statements:

1. mRNA vaccine does not contain the small or inactivated disease of the disease-causing organism.
2. The vaccines are safer and effective as compared to traditional vaccines.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
(b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2
(d) Neither 1 nor 2

96. With reference to Animal Husbandry, consider the following statements:

1. It helps to recycle the crop residues and agricultural products effectively.
2. It provides employment to about 8.8% of the population in India.
3. Livestock sector contributes around one-fourth of total Agriculture GDP.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3



641, प्रथम तल, मुखर्जी
नगर, दिल्ली-110009

21, पूसा रोड, करोल
बाग, नई दिल्ली

13/15, ताशकंद मार्ग, निकट पत्रिका
चौराहा, सिविल लाइन्स, प्रयागराज

प्लॉट नंबर-45 व 45-A हर्ष टावर-2,
मेन टॉक रोड, वसुंधरा कॉलोनी, जयपुर

27

दूरभाष : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com



97. 'Atal Bimit Vyakti Kalyan Yojna' is related to
- Accidental insurance for the workers in unorganised sector
 - Premium payment of life insurance for below poverty line persons
 - Unemployment benefit to workers under ESI scheme.
 - None of the above

98. With reference to the National Internet Exchange of India, consider the following statements:

- It is a not for profit organization that shares data between the Internet Service Providers and Content Delivery Networks.
- It manages the Internet country code domain for India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- 1 only
- 2 only
- Both 1 and 2
- Neither 1 nor 2

99. Consider the following statements:

- In a multi cropping system, farmers grow two or more crops on farmland in one calendar year.
- A multi cropping system, includes inter-cropping, mixed-cropping and relay cropping.
- Intercropping involves growing more than one crop simultaneously without any distinct row arrangement.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- 1 only
- 1 and 2 only
- 2 and 3 only
- 1, 2 and 3

100. The 'State of World Population Report' is published by:

- National Commission on Population
- World Population Balance
- Population Media Center
- United Nations Population Fund



641, प्रथम तल, मुखर्जी
नगर, दिल्ली-110009

21, पूसा रोड, करोल
बाग, नई दिल्ली

13/15, ताशकंद मार्ग, निकट पत्रिका
चौराहा, सिविल लाइन्स, प्रयागराज

प्लॉट नंबर-45 व 45-A हर्ष टावर-2,
मेन टॉक रोड, वसुंधरा कॉलोनी, जयपुर

29

दूरभाष : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com



Space for Rough Work
(रफ कार्य के लिये स्थान)

**Test Code:
2204**

(English Version)

**ANSWER & EXPLANATION
GENERAL STUDIES**

TEST – 04

D

ANSWERS

Q. No.	Answers	Q. No.	Answers	Q. No.	Answers	Q. No.	Answers
1	(b)	26	(d)	51	(c)	76	(a)
2	(b)	27	(c)	52	(c)	77	(a)
3	(c)	28	(b)	53	(c)	78	(d)
4	(d)	29	(c)	54	(b)	79	(a)
5	(c)	30	(c)	55	(c)	80	(b)
6	(a)	31	(a)	56	(c)	81	(b)
7	(c)	32	(b)	57	(d)	82	(a)
8	(d)	33	(c)	58	(b)	83	(c)
9	(a)	34	(a)	59	(c)	84	(c)
10	(a)	35	(b)	60	(a)	85	(a)
11	(a)	36	(c)	61	(a)	86	(b)
12	(a)	37	(a)	62	(c)	87	(c)
13	(c)	38	(a)	63	(b)	88	(b)
14	(b)	39	(a)	64	(c)	89	(b)
15	(c)	40	(a)	65	(c)	90	(d)
16	(c)	41	(c)	66	(a)	91	(d)
17	(a)	42	(b)	67	(c)	92	(b)
18	(c)	43	(b)	68	(d)	93	(c)
19	(b)	44	(b)	69	(a)	94	(b)
20	(b)	45	(c)	70	(a)	95	(c)
21	(c)	46	(b)	71	(c)	96	(d)
22	(a)	47	(d)	72	(d)	97	(c)
23	(a)	48	(a)	73	(a)	98	(c)
24	(c)	49	(c)	74	(c)	99	(b)
25	(a)	50	(a)	75	(a)	100	(d)



1. (b)

Explanation:**Pre-1991 economic scenario in India:**

- India sought an alternative to the extreme variations of capitalism and socialism.
- India adopted a socialist society with a strong public sector but also with private property and democracy.
- As part of it, India adopted a centralised planning approach.

1991 economic crisis:

- By 1985, India had started having balance of payments problems.
- By the end of 1990, the government was close to default.
- In 1991, India met with an economic crisis - relating to external debt. The government was not able to make repayments on its borrowings from abroad.
- The foreign exchange reserves, dropped to levels that were not sufficient to last even a fortnight.
- The crisis was further compounded by rising prices of essential goods.

1991 Economic Reforms consisted of two parts:

- **Stabilisation measures:**
 - These are short term measures aimed at solving the immediate cause the 1991 economic crisis.
 - These included correcting the weakness which resulted in the balance of payments crisis and steps to bring inflation under control.
- **Structural measures:**
 - These are long term measures aimed at improving the efficiency of the economy and increasing its international competitiveness by removing the rigidities in various segments of the Indian economy.
 - **These reforms fall under three leads:**
 - ◆ Liberalisation
 - ◆ Globalisation
 - ◆ Privatisation

The Major Policy Changes Include:

- **Abolishing Industrial licensing for industries except:- alcohol, cigarettes, hazardous chemicals, drugs, explosives, etc. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Many industries which were reserved for public sector had been 'dereserved'.
- Reduce the role of RBI from regulator to facilitator of financial sector.
- **These reforms led to the establishment of private banks. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

- Corporate tax, which was very high earlier was gradually reduced.
- The rupee was 'devalued' against foreign currencies which led to an increase in inflow of foreign exchange.
- Reduction of tariff rates (taxes on imports)
- **Export duties were removed to promote exports. Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

2. (b)

Explanation:

- According to the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, highest share of funds for the Smart Cities Mission is provided by the central and state governments. After this, Public Private Partnerships provide the second largest source of funding for the Mission. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Union Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs is the nodal ministry for Smart Cities Mission. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- Prime Minister launched three mega urban schemes viz. **Smart Cities Mission, Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation (AMRUT)** and Housing for All in urban area, setting in motion the process of urban transformation to enable better living and drive economic growth.

3. (c)

Explanation:

- There are six countries (**Saudi Arabia, Yemen, Egypt, Sudan, Eritrea, and Djibouti**) bordering the Red Sea. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**

641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 11000921, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, PrayagrajPlot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

2

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com



4. (d)

Explanation:

- A **Sovereign Wealth Fund (SWF)** is a state-owned investment fund or entity which comprises pools of money derived from a country's reserves.
 - Reserves are funds set aside for investment to benefit the country's economy and its citizens.
 - Funding comes from central bank reserves, currency operations, privatizations, transfer payments, and revenue from exporting natural resources.
 - Funds tend to prefer returns over liquidity and are therefore more risk-tolerant than traditional foreign exchange reserves.
- Sovereign wealth funds are piling into India, buying stakes in everything from airports to renewable energy, attracted by political stability, a growing middle class and reforms making it more enticing for foreigners to invest.
- India is popular with sovereign wealth funds.
- Almost every jurisdiction in the western world is raising the bar for entry for foreign investors but in India it's the other way round.
- There's also the attraction of the demographics and a lot of assets that sovereign funds like, such as **infrastructure**, where there's a huge appetite for foreign funding.
- The **rapid rise of an educated middle class** offers enormous opportunities for the deployment of long-term capital, the kind that sovereign wealth funds are ideally suited to provide.
- **Regulatory reforms** are also bolstering sentiment and drawing in wealth funds.
- Its increased interest in India is driven by the country's strong growth potential, **positive demographics** and continued economic development. **Hence, statement 1, 2, 3 and 4 are correct.**

5. (c)

Explanation:

Disk-Footed Bat:

- **Meghalaya** has yielded **India's first bamboo-dwelling bat with sticky disks**, taking the species count of the **flying mammal in the country to 130. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The **disk-footed bat** (*Eudiscopus denticulus*) was recorded in the **north-eastern States** Laila Area near the **Nongkhyllem Wildlife Sanctuary**, about 1,000 km west of its nearest known habitat in Myanmar.

- **IUCN Status: Least Concern. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The **disk-footed bat** has raised Meghalaya's bat count to 66, the most for any State in India. It has also helped add a genus and species to the bat fauna of India.

6. (a)

Explanation:

- The USA is one of the few countries with which **India has a trade surplus. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - **Trade surplus** is a situation in which a country sells more to other countries than it buys from other countries : the amount of money by which a country's exports are greater than its imports.
 - India's trade surplus with the USA increased to USD 17.42 billion in 2019-20 from USD 16.86 billion in 2018-19.
- For the USA, **India was the sixth largest supplier of services imports. Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- India's large market, economic growth, and progress towards development make it an essential market for USA exporters.
- The **Generalized System of Preferences (GSP)** is a USA trade program designed to promote economic growth in the developing world by providing preferential duty-free entry for up to 4,800 products from 129 designated beneficiary countries and territories.
- Effective from June 2019, the **USA decided to withdraw duty-free benefits to Indian exporters** under the GSP programme. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

7. (c)

Explanation:

World Trade Organization's Appellate Body

Global trade disputes are complex and difficult to resolve. For proper enforcement of trade rules, a binding, **two-stage dispute settlement system** was established at the World Trade Organization in the 1990s. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

The **Appellate Body** is the platform of the dispute settlement system, with seven standing members.

- **Stage 1:** for adjudicating trade disputes, a panel would decide cases brought before it by the members. Rulings issued by the panels can be appealed at the Appellate Body.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

3

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- **Stage 2:** the Appellate Body can uphold, modify or reverse the legal findings and conclusions of a panel.
- Therefore, the Appellate Body's decisions are final and adopted within 30 days by the dispute settlement body. **Sanctions can be imposed** on a member in case of its failure to comply with the Appellate Body's rulings. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The establishment of the Appellate Body has given teeth and credibility to the rules-based multilateral trading system. Moreover, it provided security and predictability in the multilateral trading system.

8. (d)

Explanation:

Anamaya initiative:

- It is an initiative **bringing together governments, philanthropists, national and international foundations, Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs)/Community Based Organizations (CBOs)** to end all preventable deaths among the tribal communities of India.
- It will converge efforts of various Government agencies and organisations to enhance the health and nutrition status of the **tribal communities of India. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- It aims to build a **sustainable, high-performing health ecosystem** to address the key health challenges faced by the tribal population of India.
- It was launched by the **Ministry of Tribal Affairs. Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

9. (a)

Explanation:

When a country faces **serious medium-term balance of payments problems because of structural weaknesses** that require time to address, the International Monetary Fund (IMF) can assist with the adjustment process under an **Extended Fund Facility (EFF). Hence, option (a) is correct.**

The EFF was established to provide assistance to countries:

- experiencing serious payments imbalances because of structural impediments;
- characterized by slow growth and an inherently weak balance of payments position. The EFF provides

assistance in support of comprehensive programs that include policies of the scope and character required to correct structural imbalances over an extended period.

The **Special Drawing Right (SDR)** is an international reserve asset, created by the IMF in 1969 to supplement its member countries' official reserves. The value of the SDR is based on a basket of **five currencies**—the **U.S. dollar, the euro, the Chinese renminbi, the Japanese yen, and the British pound sterling.**

10. (a)

Explanation:

- All these terms come from the theoretical physics branch, which investigates the state of matter and composition, origin, and extent of the universe.
- **Singularity and event horizons** are related to **Black Holes.**
- The **standard model of physics** tries to explain **Universal Phenomena.**
- **String theory** is used in the context of **Quantum physics** that is used to understand quantum phenomena. **Hence, option (a) is correct.**

11. (a)

Explanation:

The **COP21** to the **United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change** decided to convene a facilitative dialogue among Parties in 2018 to take stock of the collective efforts of Parties in relation to progress towards the long-term goal (referred to in Article 4, paragraph 1, of the Paris Agreement). To this end The Talanoa Dialogue was launched at the **UN Climate Change Conference COP-23 in Bonn (Germany) in 2017 . Hence, statement (a) is correct.**

12. (a)

Explanation:

- **EASE Reforms Agenda:** It was **launched in January 2018** jointly by the Government and Public Sector Banks (PSBs). It was commissioned through Indian Banks' Association and authored by Boston Consulting Group. **EASE Agenda is aimed at institutionalizing CLEAN and SMART banking. Hence, statement 1 is correct and statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- **EASE Reforms Index:** It measures the performance of each PSB on **120+ objective metrics.** The Index follows



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

4

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



a **fully transparent scoring methodology**, which enables banks to identify their strengths as well as areas for improvement. The goal is to continue driving change by encouraging healthy competition among PSBs.

- **EASE 1.0 Index:** It showed **significant improvement** in PSB performance in the resolution of Non Performing Assets (NPAs) transparently.
- **EASE 2.0 Index:** It was **announced recently on the performance of PSBs from March 2018-2020** and the best-performing banks on EASE were felicitated. It builds on the foundation of **EASE 1.0** and introduces new reform Action Points across six themes to make reforms journey irreversible, strengthen processes and systems, and drive outcomes.
- **The six themes of EASE 2.0 are -**
 - I. Responsible Banking;
 - II. Customer Responsiveness;
 - III. Credit Off-take;
 - IV. PSBs as UdyamiMitra (SIDBI portal for credit management of MSMEs);
 - V. Financial Inclusion & Digitalisation; and
 - VI. Governance and HR
- **Performance of PSB on EASE 2.0 Index-**
 1. **Overall Score:** It increased by 37% between March-2019 and March-2020, with the average EASE index score improving from 49.2 to 67.4 out of 100.
 2. **Top Performing Banks:** Bank of Baroda, State Bank of India, and erstwhile Oriental Bank of Commerce.
 3. **Major improvements:**
 - I. **Digital Banking:** Nearly 4 crore active customers on mobile and internet banking. 50% of financial transactions through digital channels.
 - II. **Customer service:** Increase in the number of call centers and inclusion of 13 regional languages in customer service, enhanced doorstep banking support by 75,000+ Bank Mitras, etc.
 - III. **Easy loans:** Turnaround time for retail loans reduced from nearly 30 days to nearly 10 days.
 - IV. **NPAs and Frauds:** Gross NPAs reduced from Rs. 8.96 lakh crore in March-2018 to Rs. 6.78 lakh crore in March-2020. A sharp decline in

fraud occurrence from 0.65% of advances during FY10-FY14 to 0.06% in FY19-20. Record recovery of Rs. 2.27 lakh crore in FY19-FY20. Banks have taken steps like instituting data-driven risk assessments and introducing Early Warning Signals (EWS) systems.

13. (c)

Explanation:

Indian Energy Exchange:

- It is the **first and largest** energy exchange in India providing a **nationwide, automated trading platform** for physical delivery of electricity, Renewable Energy Certificates and Energy Saving Certificates.
- The exchange platform enables **efficient price discovery and increases the accessibility and transparency** of the power market in India while also enhancing the speed and efficiency of trade execution.
- It is a **publicly listed company** with National Stock Exchange (NSE) and Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE).
- It is **approved and regulated by Central Electricity Regulatory Commission (CERC)** and has been operating since 2008. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- It aims to leverage technology and innovation to establish transparent and efficient energy marketplaces for delivering affordable, reliable energy to consumers.

Central Electricity Regulatory Commission (CERC):

- CERC is a regulator of the power sector in India.
- It intends to promote competition, efficiency and economy in bulk power markets, improve the quality of supply, promote investments and advise the government on the removal of institutional barriers to bridge the demand-supply gap. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

14. (b)

Explanation:

- Build-Operate-Transfer (**BOT**), Hybrid Annuity Model (**HAM**) and Engineering, Procurement, and Construction (EPC) are the different types of Public-Private Partnership (PPP).
 - BOT is a conventional PPP model in which a private partner is responsible to design, build, operate (during the contracted period) and transfer back the facility to the public sector.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

5

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- In the case of HAM, the central government bears 40% of the project cost and the remaining amount is arranged by the developer.
- Under the EPC model, the cost is completely borne by the government.

Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct while statement 2 is correct.

15. (c)

Explanation:

Aditya - L1 First Indian mission to study the Sun

- The Aditya-1 mission was conceived as a 400kg class satellite carrying one payload, the **Visible Emission Line Coronagraph (VELC)** and was planned to launch in an 800 km low earth orbit.
- A Satellite placed in the halo orbit around the **Lagrangian point 1 (L1)** of the Sun-Earth system has the major advantage of **continuously viewing the Sun without any occultation/ eclipses**. Hence, statement 1 is correct.
- Therefore, the Aditya-1 mission has now been revised to the “**Aditya-L1 mission**” and will be inserted in a **halo orbit around the L1**, which is **1.5 million km from the Earth**. Hence, statement 2 is correct.
- The satellite carries additional **six payloads** with enhanced science scope and objectives.

16. (c)

Explanation:

- The ‘National Bureau of Plant Introduction’ was renamed as ‘**National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources**’ (NBPGR) in January 1977.
- It is a nodal organisation in India for management of **Plant Genetic Resources (PGR)**.
- It is one of the **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)** Institutes. ICAR is an autonomous organisation under the **Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers’ Welfare**.
- The establishment of the Bureau coincided with the advent of the Green Revolution and was **in response to the realization of perceived effects of the Green Revolution on agrobiodiversity**. Hence, statement 1 is correct.
- It was in accordance with the international developments in the form of establishment of the **International Board for Plant Genetic Resources (IBPGR), Rome, in 1974** (now renamed as International Plant Genetic Resources Institute).

- It has played a pivotal role in the **improvement of various crop plants and diversification and development of agriculture** in India through **germplasm introduction** from various institutes/organizations located in **foreign countries and germplasm collection from within the country** and abroad and conservation thereof. Hence, statement 2 is correct.

17. (a)

Explanation:

The Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA) has launched Pradhan Mantri Street Vendor’s Atma Nirbhar Nidhi (PM SVANidhi), for providing **affordable loans to street vendors**. Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.

- Earlier, the scheme was announced as a part of the **Economic Stimulus-II** under the **Atmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyan**.
- The scheme would benefit vendors, hawkers, thelewale and people involved in goods and services related to textiles, apparel, artisan products, barbers shops, laundry services etc. in different areas.

Features of PM SVANidhi

- **Loan facility:**
 - The vendors can avail a working capital loan of up to Rs. 10,000, which is repayable in monthly instalments within a year. The loans would be without collateral.
 - ◆ It is for the first time that **Microfinance Institutions, Non-Banking Financial Company, Self Help Groups** have been allowed in a scheme for the urban poor due to their ground level presence and proximity to the urban poor including the street vendors.
- **There will be no penalty on early repayment of loan.**
 - ◆ Early repayment (or resettlement) is a clearance of debt or loan before the scheduled time. Many banks and lenders charge penalties for repaying loans early.
- Those who were vending till 24th March, 2020 can avail the benefits of the scheme.
 - ◆ This is for the first time that street vendors from peri- urban/rural areas have become beneficiaries of an urban livelihood programme.
- The scheme is valid until March 2022.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

6

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- **Interest Subsidy:**
 - On timely/early repayment of the loan, an interest subsidy of 7% per annum will be credited to the bank accounts of beneficiaries through direct benefit transfer on a six monthly basis.
- **Escalation of credit limits:**
 - The scheme provides for the **rise of the credit limit on timely/ early repayment of loans** i.e. if a street vendor repays the installments on time or earlier, he or she can develop his or her credit score that makes him/her eligible for a higher amount of term loan such as Rs. 20,000.
- **Encourage digital transactions:**
 - The scheme incentivises digital transactions by the street vendors through monthly cash back.
- **Focus on capacity building:**
 - MoHUA in collaboration with State Governments will **launch a capacity building and financial literacy programme of all the stakeholders and Information, Education and Communication (IEC) activities** throughout the country during the month of June and loaning will commence in the month of July.
- **Role of Urban Local Bodies (ULBs):**
 - ULBs will play a pivotal role in the implementation of the scheme by **ensuring to target the beneficiary and reaching to them in an efficient manner. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **E-governance:**
 - In line with the vision of leveraging technology to ensure effective delivery and transparency, a digital platform with web portal/ mobile app is being developed to administer the scheme with end-to-end solution.
 - This platform will integrate the web portal/ mobile app with **UdyamiMitra portal of SIDBI for credit management and PAiSA portal of MoHUA to administer interest subsidy automatically.**
 - It will help in integrating the vendors into the formal financial system.

18. (c)**Explanation:****E9 Countries:**

- Recently, a consultation meeting of **Education Ministers** of E9 countries was held.

- The meeting was held on the theme '**E9 initiative: Scaling up digital learning to accelerate progress towards SDG4**'.
- E9 Partnership was first established in **1993**, formed to achieve the goals of **UNESCO's Education For All (EFA)**.
- A group of E9 countries (**Bangladesh, Brazil, China, Egypt, India, Indonesia, Mexico, Nigeria, and Pakistan**) aims at strengthening political will and collective effort to ensure quality education and lifelong learning opportunities for all. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**
- E9 Partnership is working for the achievement of **SDG4 – Quality Education 2030**.

19. (b)**Explanation:**

- The Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights (PPV&FR) Act, 2001 has sufficient provisions to protect the interests of public sector breeding institutions and the farmers.

Objectives of the PPV & FR Act, 2001

1. To establish an **effective system for the protection of plant varieties, the rights of farmers and plant breeders** and to **encourage the development of new varieties of plants.**
2. To accelerate agricultural development in the country, protect plant breeders' rights; stimulate investment for research and development both in **public & private sector** for the development of new plant varieties.
3. Facilitate the **growth of seed industry** in the country which will ensure the availability of high quality seeds and planting material to the farmers. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Farmers' Rights:

- a. A farmer who has evolved or developed a new variety is entitled for registration and protection in manner as a breeder of a variety.
- b. Farmers variety can also be registered as an extant variety.
- c. A farmer can save, use, sow, re-sow, exchange, **share or sell** his farm produce including seed of a variety protected under the PPV&FR Act, 2001. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 11000921, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, PrayagrajPlot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

7

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- d. Farmers are eligible for recognition and rewards for the conservation of Plant Genetic Resources of land races and wild relatives of economic plants.

20. (b)

Explanation:

RESPOND Program:

- Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) has announced that it will support **eight joint research projects** mooted by the **Space Technology Cell (STC), IIT-Delhi**.
 - The **ISRO** will support the projects under its **RESPOND programme** with varying duration of **1-3 years**.
 - **STC** was set up at IIT, Delhi under an MoU signed between the **ISRO and IIT-D** in November 2019.
 - **Aim of STC:** To strengthen the research collaboration between the two organisations and to carry out focused research projects in the space technology domain with specific deliverables.
 - Since then, **eight collaborative research projects** have been announced.
 - Some of the projects include **developing a system for drought and flood forecasting and understanding land-atmosphere interactions**.
 - **Main objectives of the RESPOND Programme:** To establish strong links with premier academic institutions in India to carry out research and developmental projects which are of relevance to Space and derive useful outputs of such R&D to support ISRO programmes.
- Hence, option (b) is correct.

21. (c)

Explanation:

- According to **NSO-EUS** (National Statistical Office-Employment Unemployment Survey) and **PLFS** (Periodic Labour Force Survey) estimates, female labour force participation rate (**LFPR**) for productive age-group (15-59 years) shows a declining trend.
 - Female labour force participation declined by 7.8 percentage points from 33.1 per cent in 2011-12 to 25.3 per cent in 2017-18.
 - **Though female LFPR is higher in rural areas as compared to urban areas, the rate of decline was also sharper in rural areas compared to urban areas.**
- Hence, statement 1 and 2 are correct.

- As a result of this, gender disparity in India's labour market has increased which is reflected from declining trend in ratio of female to male labour force participation rate except for urban females.
- In urban areas, female labour force participation more or less remained constant.

22. (a)

Explanation:

- The World Bank is an international organization dedicated to providing financing, advice, and research to developing nations to aid their economic advancement.
- The bank predominantly acts as an organization that attempts to fight poverty by offering developmental assistance to middle- and low-income countries.
- Currently, the World Bank has **two stated goals** that it aims to achieve by 2030.
 - The **first** is to **end extreme poverty** by decreasing the number of people living on less than \$1.90 a day to below 3% of the world population.
 - The **second** is to **increase overall prosperity** by increasing income growth in the bottom 40% of every country in the world.
- **The Institutions of the World Bank Group:**
 - The World Bank Group is one of the world's largest sources of funding and knowledge for developing countries.
 - It consists of **five institutions** with a common commitment to reducing poverty, increasing shared prosperity, and promoting sustainable growth and development.
- ◆ **The International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)** lends to governments of middle-income and creditworthy low-income countries.
- ◆ **International Development Association (IDA)** provides financing on highly concessional terms to governments of the poorest countries. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ◆ **The International Finance Corporation (IFC)** provides loans, equity, and advisory services to stimulate private sector investment in developing countries. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ◆ **Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA)** provides political risk insurance and credit enhancement to investors and lenders to facilitate foreign direct investment in emerging economies.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

8

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- ◆ **International Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID)** provides international facilities for conciliation and arbitration of investment disputes.

23. (a)

Explanation:

Sagarmala Project

- The Sagarmala Programme was approved by the Union Cabinet in 2015 which aims at **holistic port infrastructure development** along the 7,516-km long coastline through modernisation, mechanisation and computerisation. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- Under this port-led development framework, the government hopes to increase its cargo traffic three-fold.
- It also includes the **establishment of rail/road linkages with the port terminals**, thus providing last-mile connectivity to ports; development of linkages with new regions enhanced multi-modal connectivity including rail, inland water, coastal and road services. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- The **Union Ministry of Shipping** has been appointed as the nodal ministry for this initiative. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

24. (c)

Explanation:

The Union Cabinet has approved the new National Education Policy (NEP), 2020 with an aim to introduce several changes in the Indian education system - from the school to college level.

Salient Feature of New National Education Policy 2020:

- Universalization of education from preschool to secondary level with 100% Gross Enrolment Ratio (GER) in school education by 2030.
- To bring 2 crore out of school children back into the mainstream through an open schooling system.
- The current 10+2 system is to be replaced by a **new 5+3+3+4 curricular structure** corresponding to ages 3-8, 8-11, 11-14, and 14-18 years respectively.
- It will **bring the uncovered age group of 3-6 years under school curriculum**, which has been recognized globally as the crucial stage for development of mental faculties of a child. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- It will also have 12 years of schooling with three years of Anganwadi/ pre schooling.

- School governance is set to change, with a new accreditation framework and an independent authority to regulate both public and private schools.
- Emphasis on Foundational Literacy and Numeracy, no rigid separation between academic streams, extracurricular, vocational streams in schools.
- Vocational Education to start from Class 6 with Internships.
- Teaching up to at least **Grade 5 to be in mother tongue/ regional language**. No language will be imposed on any student. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- Assessment reforms with 360 degree Holistic Progress Card, tracking Student Progress for achieving Learning Outcomes
- A new and comprehensive National Curriculum Framework for Teacher Education (NCFTE) 2021, will be formulated by the National Council for Teacher Education (NCTE) in consultation with National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT).
- By 2030, the minimum degree qualification for teaching will be a 4-year integrated B.Ed. degree.

25. (a)

Explanation:

Boao Forum for Asia (BFA)

- **Headquarter:** China
- It is an **international organization** jointly initiated by 29 member states.
- It holds its **annual conference in Boao, Hainan, China on a regular basis.**
- **Founding purpose:** To promote economic integration in Asia.
- It is a **Not-For-Profit Organisation**. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **Mission:** To pool positive energy for the development of Asia and the world.
- **First conference:** Feb. 26-27, 2001
- It is modelled on the **World Economic Forum held annually in Davos, Switzerland.**
- **India is a member** of this organisation. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

26. (d)

Explanation:

Pradhan Mantri Kisan SAMPADA Yojana

- In **2016**, Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI) introduced an umbrella **Scheme for Agro-Marine**



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

9

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



Processing and Development of Agro-Processing Clusters or SAMPADA, which was proposed to be implemented with an allocation of ₹6,000 crores for the period of 2016-20.

- In **2017**, SAMPADA was **renamed** as the **Pradhan Mantri Kisan Sampada Yojana (PMKSY)**.
- It is a **Central Sector Scheme**.
- **Objectives:**
 - To **supplement agriculture**.
 - To create **processing and preservation capacities**.
 - To **modernise and expand** existing food processing units with a view to **increasing the level of processing**.
 - To **add value** leading to the **reduction of wastage**.
- **Seven schemes implemented under PMKSY are:**
 - **Mega Food Parks**.
 - **Integrated Cold Chain and Value Addition Infrastructure**.
 - **Infrastructure for Agro-Processing Clusters**.
 - **Creation of Backward and Forward Linkages**.
 - **Creation/Expansion of Food Processing & Preservation Capacities**.
 - **Food Safety and Quality Assurance Infrastructure**.
 - **Human Resources and Institutions**.

Hence, option (d) is correct.

- Under PMKSY, **capital subsidy** in the form of **grants-in-aid ranging from 35% to 75%** of the eligible project cost **subject to a maximum specified limit** is provided to investors under the various schemes for **undertaking infrastructure, logistic projects and setting up of food processing units** in the country.

Note: National Agriculture Market (eNAM) is a pan-India electronic trading portal which networks the existing APMC mandis to create a unified national market for agricultural commodities.

27. (c)

Explanation:

Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank

- The Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) is a multilateral development bank with a mission to improve social and economic outcomes in Asia.
- It is established by the **AIIB Articles of Agreement (entered into force 25th December 2015)** which is a multilateral treaty.

- **Headquarters:** Beijing, China
- **Members:**
 - 102 members.
 - **India joined AIIB in 2016** as a regional member of the Bank.
 - Further, fourteen of the **G-20 nations** are AIIB members including France, Germany, Italy and the United Kingdom.
- China is the largest shareholder in AIIB with a 26.06% voting power, followed by India with a 7.62% voting power.
- The Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) has approved a \$356.67-million loan to the Government of India to support the expansion of the metro rail network in the southern Indian city of Chennai. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

Asian Development Bank

- ADB is a regional development bank established on 19th December 1966.
- **Headquarters:** Manila, Philippines.
- **Members:**
 - It has 68 members, 49 from within Asia.
 - **India is a founding member.**
- **As of 31 December 2019, ADB's five largest shareholders are Japan and the United States (each with 15.6% of total shares), the People's Republic of China (6.4%), India (6.3%), and Australia (5.8%). Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- It is committed to achieving a prosperous, inclusive, resilient, and sustainable Asia and the Pacific while sustaining its efforts to eradicate extreme poverty.
- The **Asian Development Outlook (ADO)** released by the Asian Development Bank (ADB), the Indian economy is expected to contract by 4% during the current financial year (2020-21).

28. (b)

Explanation:

- Recently, the **Marine Products Exports Development Authority (MPEDA)** has developed a certification scheme for aquaculture products called '**Shaphari**'.
- Shaphari is **based on the United Nations' Food and Agriculture Organization's technical guidelines** on aquaculture certification. **Hence, option (b) is correct.**



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

10

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- Shaphari is a Sanskrit word that means the superior quality of fishery products suitable for human consumption.
- It is a **market-based tool for hatcheries to adopt good aquaculture practices** and help produce quality antibiotic-free shrimp products to assure global consumers.

29. (c)

Explanation:

The Farmers' Produce Trade and Commerce (Promotion and Facilitation) Act, 2020

Main provisions –

- The new legislation has created an ecosystem where the farmers and traders will enjoy the freedom of choice of **sale and purchase of agri-produce**.
- It will also promote **barrier-free inter-state and intra-state trade** and commerce outside the physical premises of markets notified under State Agricultural Produce Marketing legislations. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The farmers will not be **charged any cess or levy for sale of their products** and will not have to bear transport costs. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The Act also proposes electronic trading in transaction platform for ensuring a seamless trade electronically.
- In addition to mandis, freedom to do trading at farmgate, cold storage, warehouse, processing units etc.
- Farmers will be able to engage in direct marketing thereby eliminating intermediaries resulting in full realization of price.

30. (c)

Explanation:

Coal Gasification:

- Coal gasification is the process of **converting coal into synthesis gas** (also called syngas), which is a **mixture of hydrogen (H₂), carbon monoxide (CO), and carbon dioxide (CO₂)**.
- The syngas can be used in a variety of applications such as in the **production of electricity and making chemical products, such as fertilizers**.
- The coal gasification process holds good potential in the future, with coal being the most abundantly available fossil fuel across the world, and that even low-grade coal can be used in the process. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**

31. (a)

Explanation:

- IBSA is a **tripartite group consisting of India, Brazil, and South Africa**.

- IBSA was formed after the signing of the **Brasilia Declaration** in the year **2003**. **Hence statement 1 is correct.**

- BRICS was founded in 2006 and IBSA does not function under BRICS. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

32. (b)

Explanation:

- Fisheries is a fast-growing sector in India, which provides nutrition and food security to a large population of the country besides providing income and employment to more than 14.5 million people.
- India was the **second largest fish producer in the world** with a total production of 13.7 million metric tonnes in 2018-19. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Of the total production of fish, 65% is from inland sector. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

33. (c)

Explanation:

Marine Products Exports Development Authority:

- MPEDA is a **nodal coordinating, state-owned agency** engaged in **fishery production and allied activities**. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- It was established in **1972** under the **Marine Products Export Development Authority Act (MPEDA), 1972**.
- It functions under the **Union Ministry of Commerce and Industry**. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- Its mandate is to **increase exports of seafood** including fisheries of all kinds, specifying standards, marketing, processing, extension and training in various aspects. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**

34. (a)

Explanation:

- India's first trans-shipment hub is located at the Cochin Port. **Hence, option (a) is correct.**
- Trans-shipment Hub is the terminal at the port which handles containers, stores them temporarily and transfers them to other ships for the onward destination.

35. (b)

Explanation:

Diabetes:

- Diabetes is a **Non-Communicable Disease (NCD)** that occurs either when the **pancreas does not produce**



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

11

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



enough insulin (a hormone that regulates blood sugar, or glucose) or when the body cannot effectively use the insulin it produces. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

About Global Diabetes Compact Initiative:

- **Global Diabetes Compact** aims to **reduce the risk of diabetes. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- It will ensure that all people diagnosed with diabetes have access to equitable, **comprehensive, affordable, quality treatment and care.**
- This initiative was launched at the **Global Diabetes Summit. WHO** and the government of Canada Co-hosted the summit with the support of the University of Toronto.

36. (c)

Explanation:

- Agricultural Census is conducted **every five years** in India. It is the **largest countrywide statistical operation undertaken by the Ministry of Agriculture**, for collection of data on the structure of operational holdings by different size classes and social groups. **Hence, statement 1 is correct**
- The first Agricultural Census in the country was conducted with reference year 1970-71.
- Agricultural Census is carried out as a Central Sector Scheme under which **100% financial assistance** is provided to States/Union Territories. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The tenth Agriculture Census with reference year 2015-16 has been launched on 3rd February, 2016. The field work of Phase-I of Agriculture Census 2015-16 has been completed and provisional results of Phase-I are being processed.

37. (a)

Explanation:

National Digital Health Mission (NDHM)

- The project provide a health ID to every person in the country, and benefit the poor.
- It seeks to provide efficient and affordable health coverage through a wide-range of data and infrastructure services.
- The **key feature of this mission is the technology part** - it will leverage open digital systems to provide high-quality healthcare for all. It will integrate various digital health services to create an ecosystem which can assimilate existing health information systems.

- Under NDHM, Indian citizens will get a **digital health ID** which is basically a digital format of all his/her health records which will be linked to the registry of doctors and health facilities across the country. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **The enrolment in the initiative will be voluntary. Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- The health ID will contain information about medical data, prescriptions and diagnostic reports and summaries of previous discharge from hospitals for ailments. The mission is expected to bring efficiency and transparency in healthcare services in the country.
- The NDHM comprises **six key building blocks or digital systems - HealthID, DigiDoctor, Health Facility Registry, Personal Health Records, e-Pharmacy and Telemedicine** - that will enable access to timely, safe and affordable healthcare through a 'citizen-centric' approach.
- **The National Health Authority (NHA)**, the apex agency responsible for the implementation of Ayushman Bharat Pradhan Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana (**AB-PMJAY**), has been given the mandate by the government to design, build, roll-out and implement the NDHM in the country. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**

38. (a)

Explanation:

Mahatma Jyotirao Phule

- Phule was born on **11th April 1827** in present-day **Maharashtra** and belonged to the Mali caste of gardeners and vegetable farmers.
- His Ideology was based on: **Liberty; Egalitarianism; Socialism.**
- Phule was influenced by Thomas Paine's book titled **The Rights of Man** and believed that the **only solution to combat the social evils was the enlightenment of women and members of the lower castes. Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- **Tritiya Ratna (1855); Powada: Chatrapati Shivajiraje Bhosle Yancha (1869); Gulamgiri (1873), Shetkarayacha Aasud (1881)** are his major publications. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- He was appointed **commissioner to the Poona municipality** and served in the position until 1883.
- He was bestowed with the **title of Mahatma** on 11th May 1888 by a Maharashtrian social activist Vithalrao Krishnaji Vandekar.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

12

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- He worked for the **abolishment of untouchability and the caste system in Maharashtra**. Hence, statement 3 is correct.

39. (a)

Explanation:

Institutional Deliveries in India

- **Description:**
 - Institutional delivery means **giving birth to a child in a medical institution** under the overall supervision of **trained and competent health personnel**.
 - It also signifies an availability of amenities to handle the situation and save the life of the mother and child.
- **National Scenario:**
 - Over the past two decades, India has made **progress in increasing the number of institutional deliveries**.
 - ◆ According to the **National Family Health Survey (NFHS-4)**, institutional deliveries have **increased from 39% in 2005-06 to 79% in 2015-16**.
 - ◆ Further, the institutional births in public institutions have **increased from 18% to 52%** in the same time period.
- **Step Taken to Increase Institutional Deliveries:**
 - **Janani Suraksha Yojana : Janani Suraksha Yojana (JSY)** is a **100% centrally sponsored scheme** which is being implemented with the objective of **reducing maternal and infant mortality** by promoting institutional delivery among pregnant women.
 - **Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan (PMSMA):** It has been launched to focus on conducting special **AnteNatal Check-ups (ANC) check up on 9th of every month** with the help of Medical officers to detect and **treat cases of anaemia**. Hence, statement 2 is **NOT** correct.
 - **Pradhan Mantri Matru Vandana Yojana (PMMVY):** It was introduced in 2017 and is implemented by the **Ministry of Women and Child Development**. It is a conditional cash transfer scheme for pregnant and lactating women of 19 years of age or above for the first live birth.
 - **LaQshya Programme : LaQshya (Labour room Quality Improvement Initiative)** intended to improve the quality of care in the labour room and maternity operation theatres in public health facilities. Hence, statement 1 is correct.

40. (a)

Explanation:

E-2025 initiative:

On 21 April 2021, ahead of World Malaria Day, WHO launched the E-2025 initiative to halt the **transmission of malaria in 25 identified countries by 2025**. It is built on the foundation of the E-2020 initiative.

Countries were identified by WHO across four key criteria:

- The establishment of a government-endorsed elimination plan.
- Meeting a defined threshold of malaria case reductions in recent years.
- A designated governmental agency for malaria elimination and the capacity to confirm 100% of suspected malaria cases in a laboratory.
- Selected by the Malaria Elimination Oversight Committee.
- **E-2020 initiative:** In 2016, the **World Health Organization (WHO)** identified a group of 21 countries spanning five regions to **scale up efforts to achieve malaria elimination by 2020**. The E-2020 initiative was launched in the year 2017 with an aim of **achieving zero indigenous cases of malaria within the 2020 timeline**.

Countries were identified by WHO across three key criteria:

- Trends in malaria case incidence between 2000 and 2014.
- Declared malaria objectives of affected countries.
- Opinions of WHO experts on the subject.

India's initiatives towards malaria elimination:

- India launched a 5-year National Strategic Plan for Malaria Elimination in 2017.
- The plan provided a roadmap to end malaria in 571 of 678 districts of India by 2022.
- Additionally, the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) has **recently established the Malaria Elimination Research Alliance-India (MERA-India)**, a conglomeration of partners working on malaria control. Hence, option (a) is correct.

41. (c)

Explanation:

National Handloom Day

- It is celebrated on 7th of August every year.
- The date, 7th August, was chosen as the **Swadeshi Movement was launched** on the same date in the year **1905**, which was based on **Bal Gangadhar Tilak's ideology of swadeshi**.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

13

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- On this day, the **handloom weaving community is honoured** and the **contribution of this sector is highlighted**.
- Objectives:**
 - To **generate awareness** about the handloom industry amongst the public at large and its contribution to socio-economic development.
 - To **protect India's handloom heritage** and to enable the handloom weavers and workers with greater opportunities.
 - To **ensure sustainable development** of the handloom sector thereby empowering handloom workers financially and instilling pride in their exquisite craftsmanship.
- Significance:**
 - Handloom sector is a **symbol of India's glorious cultural heritage**.
 - India's **soft power** has long been endorsed by the handloom and handicraft space. **Saree-Shawl Diplomacy** and '**Khadi diplomacy**' are some such examples.
 - The textiles and handloom sector in India is the **second-largest source of employment** to people, **after agriculture**. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - According to the **Fourth All India Handloom Census 2019-20**, 31.45 lakh households are engaged in handloom, weaving and allied activities.
 - It is an important **source of livelihood** in the country and a **key to women empowerment** as over 70% of handloom weavers and allied workers are women. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

42. (b)

Explanation:**Mahila Samridhi Yojana**

- Mahila Samridhi Yojana is implemented through **National Minorities Development and Finance Corporation (NMDFC)** under the **Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment**. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- Under the scheme women belonging to the Minorities community in tailoring, knitting, embroidery and allied trades. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The training period is of maximum six months where they are provided with a stipend of Rs.1000/- per trainee.

43. (b)

Explanation:**State of the Global Climate for 2020**

- The **World Meteorological Organization (WMO)** released its annual State of the Global Climate for 2020. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**

Highlights of the report:

- 2020 was one of the three warmest years on record, despite a cooling La Niña event.
- The emission of major greenhouse gases increased in 2019 and 2020
- Concentrations of the major greenhouse gases** in the air continued to increase in 2019 and 2020. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- In 2019, the oceans had the highest heat content on the record. In 2020, it has broken this record further.
- Over **80% of the ocean** area experienced at least one **marine heatwave** in 2020. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

44. (b)

Explanation:**Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Janaushadhi Pariyojana**

- Pradhan Mantri Bhartiya Janaushadhi Pariyojana (PMBJP) is a campaign launched by the **Department of Pharmaceuticals** in 2008 under the name Jan Aushadi Campaign.
- Bureau of Pharma PSUs of India (BPPI)** is the implementation agency for PMBJP. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
 - The Bureau of Pharma PSUs of India works under the Ministry of Chemicals & Fertilizers.
- PMBJP stores have been set up to provide generic drugs, which are available at lesser prices but are equivalent in quality and efficacy as expensive branded drugs.
- It also intends to extend the coverage of quality generic medicines so as to reduce the out of pocket expenditure on medicines and thereby redefine the unit cost of treatment per person. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- It will create awareness about generic medicines through education and publicity so that quality is not synonymous with an only high price.

45. (c)

Explanation:**Integrated Health Information Platform (IHIP)**

- The Integrated Health Information Platform is the **next generation** highly refined version of the presently used **Integrated Disease Surveillance Programme (IDSP)**.

641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 11000921, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, PrayagrajPlot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

14

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- The new version of IHIP will house the **data entry and management for India's disease surveillance program**.
- In addition to tracking 33 diseases now as compared to the earlier 18 diseases, it shall ensure **near-real-time data in digital mode**, having done away with the paper mode of working.
- It is the **world's biggest online disease surveillance platform**, is in sync with the **National Digital Health Mission** and fully compatible with the other digital information systems presently being used in India. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The refined IHIP with automated -data will help in a big way in real-time data collection, aggregation & further analysis of data that will aid and enable evidence-based policymaking.
- IHIP will provide a **health information system** developed for **real-time, case-based information, integrated analytics, and advanced visualization capability**.
- It will provide analyzed reports on mobile or other electronic devices.
- In addition, outbreak investigation activities can be initiated and monitored electronically.
- It can easily be integrated with other ongoing surveillance programs while having the feature of the addition of special surveillance modules.
- It was under the **Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare**. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

46. (b)

Explanation:

Draft Defence Production and Export Promotion Policy (2020)

- **Goals and Objectives:**
 - To achieve a turnover of Rs. 1,75,000 crore including export of Rs. 35,000 crore in Aerospace and Defence goods and services by 2025. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
 - To develop a dynamic, robust and competitive Defence industry, including Aerospace and Naval Shipbuilding industry to cater to the needs of Armed forces with quality products.
 - To reduce dependence on imports and take forward "Make in India" initiatives through domestic design and development.
 - To promote the export of defence products and become part of the global defence value chains.

- To create an environment that encourages research and development (**R&D**), rewards innovation, create Indian Intellectual Property (**IP**) ownership and promotes a robust and self-reliant defence industry.

- **Outlined Strategies:**

- **Procurement Reforms:**

- ◆ **A Project Management Unit (PMU)** will be set up for the development and production of technologies involved, life cycle costs and maintenance requirements of platforms, equipment and weapon systems.
- ◆ It also aims to move away from licensed production to design, develop and produce indigenously.
- ◆ It also aims to own the design rights and IP of the systems projected in the Long Term Integrated Perspective Plan (LTIPP) and a Technology Assessment Cell (TAC) would be created.
- ◆ The TAC would also **assess the industrial capability for design, development and production**, including re-engineering for production of major systems such as armoured vehicles, submarines, fighter aircraft, helicopters and radars with the major industries in the country.

- **Indigenisation And Support to MSMEs/Startups:**

- ◆ The indigenisation policy aims to create an industry ecosystem to indigenise the imported components (including alloys and special materials) and sub-assemblies for defence equipment and platforms manufactured in India. 5,000 such items are proposed to be indigenised by 2025.
- ◆ More than 50 startups are currently developing new 'fit-for-military-use' technologies/products.

- **Optimise Resource Allocation:**

- ◆ The share of domestic procurement in overall Defence procurement is about 60%. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- ◆ To enhance procurement from domestic industry, the procurement needs to be doubled from the current Rs. 70,000 crore to Rs. 1,40,000 crore by 2025.

- **Investment Promotion and Ease of Doing Business:**

- ◆ India is already a large aerospace market with rising passenger traffic and increasing military expenditure, as a result of which the demand for aircraft (fixed and rotary wings) is rising.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

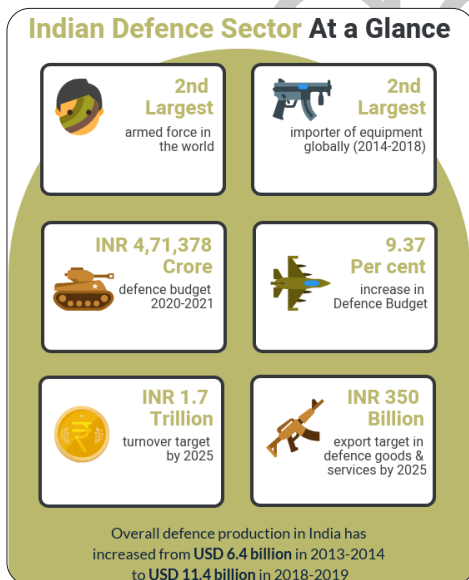
15

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- ◆ The **opportunities in the aerospace** industry have been identified in the following segments - aircraft build work, aircraft Maintenance, Repair and Overhaul (MRO), helicopters, engine manufacturing and MRO work, line replaceable units, Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs) and upgrades and retrofits.
- ◆ The **improvement in market size**, demographic dividend and availability of diverse skill sets are evident from India's ranking in the World Bank's 'Ease of Doing Business' (EoDB) report.
- ◆ The investments in the defence sector need to regularly sustain the steady supply of orders.
- **Innovation and R&D:**
 - ◆ **Innovations for Defence Excellence (iDEX)** has been operationalised to provide necessary incubation and infrastructure support to the startups in the defence area.
 - ◆ iDEX would be further scaled up to engage with 300 more startups and develop 60 new technologies/products during the next five years. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
 - ◆ **Mission Raksha Gyan Shakti** was launched to promote a greater culture of innovation and technology development and file a higher number of patents in Defence Public Sector Undertakings (DPSUs), Ordnance Factory Board (OFB). It would be scaled up for promoting the creation of Intellectual Property in the sector and its commercial utilisation.



47. (d)

Explanation:

- The **International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD)** is a global development cooperative owned by 189 member countries. As the **largest development bank** in the world, it supports the World Bank Group's Mission by providing loans, guarantees, risk management products, and advisory services to middle-income and credit worthy low-income countries, as well as by coordinating responses to regional and global challenges. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- **International Development Association (IDA)**– IDA provides loans and grants to poor countries. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- **Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA)**– MIGA seeks to encourage foreign direct investment in developing nations. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

48. (a)

Explanation:**World Press Freedom Index 2021:**

- It has been published every year since 2002 by Reporters Sans Frontieres (RSF) or Reporters Without Borders.
- The Index ranks countries and regions according to the level of freedom available to journalists. However, **it is not an indicator of the quality of journalism. Hence, statement 1 NOT correct.**
- The parameters include pluralism, media independence, media environment and self-censorship, legislative framework, transparency, and the quality of the infrastructure that supports the production of news and information.
- India was **ranked 142** in the year 2020 as well, thus showing no improvement in the environment it provides to its journalists.
- **India is among the countries classified as “bad” for journalism** and is termed as one of the most dangerous countries for journalists trying to do their jobs properly.
- **Norway has topped yet again for the fifth year in the row**, followed by Finland and Denmark. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

49. (c)

Explanation:**The Convention on Domestic Workers**

- It is the 189th **International Labour Organization (ILO)** convention. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 11000921, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, PrayagrajPlot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

16

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- India is a **signatory** to the ILO's 189th convention, known as the Convention on Domestic Workers; but has not ratified it yet. **Hence, statement 2 correct.**
- The Convention on Domestic Workers, is a convention setting labour standards for domestic workers. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

50. (a)

Explanation:

SUPACE Portal:

- It is a portal through which the **Supreme Court** intends to leverage machine learning to deal with the amount of data received in the filing of cases.
- CJI SA Bobde was the **first chairman** of the **Artificial Intelligence (AI) Committee**.
- S.A. Bobde described it as a 'hybrid system' and 'a perfect blend of human intelligence and machine learning that does wonders when paired with human intelligence.'
- The AI-driven tool is designed to only process information and make it available to the Judges to take a decision. It will **not** take any part in the decision making.
- Only the Judges of Delhi and Bombay High Courts dealing with criminal cases would use it on an experimental basis. **Hence, option (a) is correct.**

51. (c)

Explanation:

Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-National

Urban Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NULM):

- The mission was **launched in 2014** and is being implemented by the **Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs (MoHUA)**. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- It aims to uplift the urban poor by enhancing sustainable livelihood opportunities through skill development.
- It is a **Centrally Sponsored Scheme**. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
 - Fund is shared between the **Centre and the States in the ratio of 75:25**. For North Eastern and Special Category states– the ratio is 90:10.
- The **Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-National Urban Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NULM)** has been conferred the prestigious **SKOCH Governance Gold Award for its Portal for Affordable Credit and Interest Subvention Access (PAiSA)**. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- **PAiSA (Portal for Affordable Credit and Interest Subvention Access):**

- It is a centralized IT platform which simplifies and streamlines release of interest subvention under the Mission.
- It offers end to end **online solution** for processing, payment, monitoring and tracking of interest subvention claims from banks on a monthly basis.
- Claims for subvention are uploaded by banks through their CBS (Core Banking Solution) in respect of the beneficiaries of the Self Employment Programme, which are verified and approved by the Urban Local Bodies (ULB) and State concerned.
- The approved claim amount gets credited directly to the beneficiary's loan account through DBT mode.
- SMS is also sent to the beneficiary's mobile number intimating the credit of subvention amount.
- The portal has been designed and developed through the **Allahabad Bank**.

52. (c)

Explanation:

- **eSanjeevani:**

- It is a **doctor to doctor telemedicine system**, being implemented under the **Ayushman Bharat Health and Wellness Centre (AB-HWCs) programme**. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ◆ AB-HWCs are envisaged to be the platform for delivery of an expanded range of primary health care services closer to the communities.
- It seeks to **connect all 1,50,000 HWCs using the hub-and-spoke model by December 2022**.
- ◆ Under the model, a network will be established comprising an anchor establishment, or hub, which offers a full array of services, and will be complemented by secondary establishments, or spokes, which offer limited services, routing patients needing more intensive services to the hub for treatment.
- Presently, telemedicine is being provided through more than 3,000 HWCs in 10 States.

- **eSanjeevaniOPD:**

- It was **launched amid the Covid-19 pandemic** to enable **patient-to-doctor tele-consultations**.
- Offered at **no cost**, this **e-health service** has made it convenient for the people to avail of the health



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

17

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



services without having to travel. It enables **two-way interaction** and even generates a prescription slip. Hence, **statement 2 is correct.**

- It is **hosting over 40 online Out Patient Department (OPD) services**, more than half of these are speciality OPDs which include Gynaecology, Psychiatry, AntiRetroviral Therapy (ART) for the AIDS/HIV patients, Non-Communicable Disease (NCD) etc.

53. (c)

Explanation:

About the Startup India Seed Fund Scheme (SISFS):

- Its aim is to provide financial assistance to startups for proof of concept, prototype development, product trials, market-entry, and commercialization.
- It was launched by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) with an outlay of Rs. 945 Crore.
- **Some Eligibility Conditions:**
 - A startup, recognized by DPIIT, **incorporated not more than 2 years ago** at the time of application.
 - Startups should **not have received more than Rs. 10 lakh** of monetary support under any other Central or State Government scheme.

Hence, both statements 1 and 2 are correct.

54. (b)

Explanation:

Land policy formulation through planning period (Five Year Plans):

- In 1950, the Planning Commission was set up with the Prime Minister as its Chairperson.

Plan Period	Chief Issue	Policy Thrust
First Plan (1951-56)	Increase area under cultivation. Community Development networks to take care of village commons.	Increase land under cultivation. Rights to tenants to cultivate land. Abolition of intermediaries. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.
Second Plan (1956-61)	Agriculture is mostly dependent on rain alone. Low land productivity.	Soil conservation. First phase of land reform implementation. Irrigation development.

- **Land ceiling** was another policy to promote **equity** in the agricultural sector. This means fixing the maximum size of land which could be owned by an individual. The purpose of the land ceiling was to **reduce** the concentration of land ownership in a few hands. Hence, **statement 2 is correct.**
- The policy of '**land to the tiller**' is based on the idea that the cultivators will take more interest, they will have more incentive in increasing output if they are the owners of the land. This is because ownership of land enables the tiller to make profit from the increased output.

55. (c)

Explanation:

- Two types of **Narcotic Raw Material (NRM)** can be produced from **Opium Poppy - Opium Gum and Concentrate of Poppy Straw (CPS).**

Poppy Straw:

- **Poppy straw** is the **husk left** after the **opium** is **extracted from pods.**
- This poppy straw also contains a very small **morphine content** and if used in sufficient quantities, poppy straw can give a high.
- Poppy straw is one of the narcotic drugs under the **Narcotic Drugs & Psychotropic Substances Act 1985 (NDPS Act).**

Alkaloids:

- Alkaloids are a huge group of **naturally occurring organic compounds** which contain **nitrogen atoms** or amino or amido in some cases in their structures. Hence, **statement 1 is correct.**
- These nitrogen atoms cause the **alkalinity** of these compounds.
- Well-known **alkaloids** include **morphine, strychnine, quinine, ephedrine, and nicotine.**
- The medicinal properties of alkaloids are quite diverse. **Morphine** is a powerful **narcotic** used for the **relief of pain**, though its addictive properties limit its usefulness. Codeine, the methyl ether derivative of morphine found in the opium poppy, is an excellent analgesic that is relatively non-addictive.
- So far, only opium gum has been produced in India. The Government of India has now decided that CPS production should be commenced in India.
- **Current Extraction of Alkaloids:**
 - India currently only extracts **alkaloids** from **opium gum** at facilities controlled by the **Revenue Department in the Ministry of Finance.** Hence, **statement 2 is correct.**



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2 Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

18

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



56. (c)

Explanation:

Scheme for Adolescent Girls (SAG)

- **Introduced in:** 2010
- **Implemented By:** Ministry of Women and Child Development
- **Implemented Through:** Existing Anganwadi Centres (AWCs) under the Integrated Child Development Scheme (ICDS). **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- **Coverage:** Pan-India
- **Key Objective:** To facilitate, educate and empower Adolescent Girls (AGs) so as to enable them to become self-reliant and aware citizens.
- **Target Group:** Out of school girls in the age group of 11-14 years. The scheme aims at motivating out of school girls to go back to formal schooling or vocational/skill training. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- **Components:**
 - **Nutrition:** Provision for providing specified amount of calories, protein and micronutrients to AGs, etc.
 - **Non-nutrition:** Includes health check-up, mainstreaming out of school girls into the school system, Iron and Folic Acid (IFA) supplementation, life skill education etc.
- **Funding Pattern:** SAG is a centrally sponsored scheme. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
 - It is implemented through Centre and State share in the ratio of 50:50 for nutrition component and 60:40 for the rest of the activities.
 - For both components, the ratio is 90:10 for North Eastern and three Himalayan States and 100% for UTs without legislatures.
- **Achievement of the Scheme is measured through:**
 - **SAG- Rapid Reporting System (RRS):** It is a role based Management Information System (MIS) that captures details of the AGs that are taking benefits under this scheme.
 - **Kishore Health Card:** To record the information about the weight, height, Body Mass Index (BMI) of AGs along with other services provided under the scheme. These health cards for AGs are maintained at the AWCs.

57. (d)

Explanation:

The Constitution (Eighty-sixth Amendment) Act, 2002 inserted Article 21-A in the Constitution of India to provide free and compulsory education of all children in the age group of six to fourteen years as a **Fundamental Right** in such a manner as the State may, by law, determine.

The Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education (RTE) Act, 2009 also known as The Right to Education Act clarifies that 'compulsory education' means obligation of the appropriate government to provide free elementary education and ensure compulsory admission, attendance and completion of elementary education to every child in the six to fourteen age group.

- 'Free' means that no child shall be liable to pay any kind of fee or charges or expenses which may prevent him or her from pursuing and completing elementary education. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- It specifies the duties and responsibilities of appropriate Governments, local authority and parents in providing free and compulsory education, and **sharing of financial and other responsibilities between the Central and State Governments.** **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- It lays down the norms and standards relating inter alia to **Pupil Teacher Ratios (PTRs)**, buildings and infrastructure, school-working days, teacher-working hours.
- It provides for rational deployment of teachers by ensuring that the specified pupil teacher ratio is maintained for each school, rather than just as an average for the State or District or Block, thus **ensuring that there is no urban-rural imbalance in teacher postings.** **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- It also provides for prohibition of deployment of teachers for non-educational work, other than decennial census, elections to local authority, state legislatures and parliament, and disaster relief.

The Act prohibits:

- (a) physical punishment and mental harassment;
- (b) screening procedures for admission of children;
- (c) capitation fee;
- (d) private tuition by teachers and
- (e) running of schools without recognition,

641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 11000921, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, PrayagrajPlot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

19

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation

**58. (b)****Explanation:****Brucellosis disease:**

- Brucellosis is a **bacterial disease** caused by various Brucella species, which mainly **infect cattle, swine, goats, sheep and dogs**. Hence, **statement 1 is NOT correct**.
- **Humans generally acquire the disease through direct contact with infected animals**, by eating or drinking contaminated animal products, or by inhaling airborne agents. Hence, **statement 3 is NOT correct**.
- The majority of cases are caused by ingesting unpasteurized milk or cheese from infected goats or sheep.
- **Person to person transmission is rare**. Hence, **statement 2 is correct**.

59. (c)**Explanation:****Buffer Stock:**

Buffer stock refers to a reserve of a commodity that is used to offset price fluctuations and unforeseen emergencies. Buffer stock is generally maintained for essential commodities and necessities like foodgrains, pulses etc.

- The concept of buffer stock was first introduced during the **IVth Five Year Plan (1969-74)**.
- A buffer stock of food grains in the Central Pool is maintained by the Government of India (GoI) for:
 - meeting the prescribed minimum buffer stock norms for food security,
 - the monthly release of food grains for supply through the Targeted Public Distribution System (TPDS) and Other Welfare Schemes (OWS),
 - meeting emergency situations arising out of unexpected crop failure, natural disasters, etc., and
 - price stabilisation or market intervention to augment supply so as to help moderate the open market prices.
- The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs fixes the minimum buffer norms on a quarterly basis. Hence, **statement 1 is correct**.
- Government has engaged National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India Limited (NAFED), Small Farmers Agri-business Consortium (SFAC) and Food Corporation of India (FCI) to procure pulses for buffer stock.

- The Department of Consumer Affairs maintains buffer stock of pulses for the Union government under the Price Stabilisation Mechanism. Hence, **statement 2 is correct**.

60. (a)**Explanation:**

- “Sankalp se Siddhi” – Village and Digital Connect Drive was recently launched.
- **It is launched by:** Tribal Cooperative Marketing Development Federation of India Limited (TRIFED). Hence, **statement 2 is NOT correct**.

Key Points:

- It is a **100-day drive** that was started on April 1, 2021.
- It will entail 150 teams visiting ten villages each.
- **Aim:** To activate the Van Dhan Vikas Kendras in these villages. Hence, **statement 1 is correct**.
- The visiting teams will also identify locations and shortlist potential Van Dhan Vikas Kendras for clustering as TRIFOOD, and Scheme of Fund for Regeneration of Traditional Industries- (SFURTI) units as larger enterprises.
- **TRIFOOD** aims to enhance the **income of tribals** through better utilization of and value addition to the Minor Forest Produce collected by the tribal forest gatherers.

61. (a)**Explanation:**

The HDI is the composite measure of every country's attainment in three basic dimensions:

- **standard of living** measured by the gross national income (GNI) per capita;
- **health** measured by the life expectancy at birth;
- **education** levels calculated by mean years of education among the adult population and the expected years of schooling for children.

Hence, **option (a) is correct**.

62. (c)**Explanation:****Headcount Ratio:**

- The incidence of poverty is revealed by this ratio. It shows the percentage of population whose per capita income is below the poverty line. Hence, **statement 1 is correct**.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

20

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation

**Misery Index:**

The misery index (sometimes known as the Economic Discomfort Index—EDI) is simply the sum of the inflation rate plus the unemployment rate. The higher the combined score, the worse the economic situation. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

The Misery index was developed by economist Arthur Okun.

$$m_t = u_t + |\pi_t|$$

Where Unemployment rate (u_t) and the current inflation rate (π_t)

63. (b)**Explanation:****Snow Leopard:**

- They are mainly found in mountainous regions of central and northern Asia. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- In India, their geographical range encompasses:
 - **Western Himalayas:** Jammu and Kashmir, Himachal Pradesh.
 - **Eastern Himalayas:** Uttarakhand and Sikkim and Arunachal Pradesh.
- **Snow Leopard capital of the world:** Hemis, Ladakh.
- **Project Snow Leopard (PSL)** was launched to promote an inclusive and participatory approach to **conserve snow leopards and their habitat. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

64. (c)**Explanation:**

- The **Insurance Ombudsman** derives its powers from the **Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority Act, 1999. Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - In Accordance to **Redressal of Public Grievances Rules, 1998**, the office of Insurance Ombudsman was established by the Central Government.
 - Further, its powers, functions, terms of office etc. were laid in Insurance Ombudsman Rules, 2017.
- The **term of this office is three years** and it is **eligible for reappointment** provided that no person shall hold office as an Ombudsman after he has attained the age of seventy years. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- Recently the Union government **amended the Insurance Ombudsman Rules, 2017**, bringing insurance brokers within the ambit of the Insurance Ombudsman and also allowed policy holders to file online complaints. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

65. (c)**Explanation:**

- **Trade Deficit:** A trade deficit is an amount by which the cost of a country's **imports exceeds its exports.**
- It is an indicator to show a negative balance of trade. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The trade deficit in goods shows a rise in demand in the economy.
- It is a part of the **Current Account Deficit(CAD). Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

Current Account Deficit:

- The current account records **exports and imports in goods and services and transfer payments.** It represents a country's transactions with the rest of the world and, like the capital account, is a component of a country's Balance of Payments (BOP).
- There is a deficit in the Current Account if the value of the goods and services imported exceeds the value of those exported.
- **Major components are:**
 - Goods,
 - Services, and
 - Net earnings on overseas investments (such as interests and dividends) and net transfer of payments over a period of time, such as remittances.

66. (a)**Explanation:****Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank**

- The Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB) is a multilateral development bank with a mission to improve social and economic outcomes in Asia.
- It is headquartered in **Beijing** and began its operations in January 2016.
- **Fourteen of the G-20 nations** are AIIB members including France, Germany, Italy and the United Kingdom.

Membership

- Membership in the AIIB is open to all members of the **World Bank or the Asian Development Bank** and is divided into regional and non-regional members. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - Regional members are those located within areas classified as Asia and Oceania by the United Nations.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

21

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- Unlike other MDBs (multilateral development bank), the AIIB allows for non-sovereign entities to apply for AIIB membership, assuming their home country is a member.
 - Thus, sovereign wealth funds (such as the China Investment Corporation) or state-owned enterprises of member countries could potentially join the Bank.

Financial Resources of AIIB

- The AIIB's initial total capital is USD 100 billion divided into 1 million shares of 100 000 dollars each, with 20% paid-in and 80% callable.
 - **Paid-Up Share Capital:** It is the amount of money that has already been paid by investors in exchange for shares of stock.
 - **Called-Up Share Capital:** Some companies may issue shares to investors with the understanding they will be paid at a later date.
 - ◆ This allows for more flexible investment terms and may entice investors to contribute more share capital than if they had to provide funds up front.
- China is the largest contributor to the Bank, contributing USD 50 billion, half of the initial subscribed capital.
- **India is the second-largest shareholder**, contributing USD 8.4 billion.

Voting Rights

- China is the largest shareholder with 26.61 % voting shares in the bank followed by India (7.6%), Russia (6.01%) and Germany (4.2 %).
- The regional members hold 75% of the total voting power in the Bank.
- The AIIB has a governance structure similar to other MDBs (multilateral development bank), with two key differences:
 - it does not have a resident board of executive directors that represents member countries' interests on a day-to-day basis; and
 - The AIIB gives more decision making authority to regional countries and the largest shareholder, China.

AIIB Lending

- The recipients of AIIB financing may include **member countries** (or agencies and entities or enterprises in member territories), **as well as international or regional agencies** concerned with the economic development of the Asia-Pacific region.
- The bulk of AIIB's operations are in **South Asia**.

- The Bank can lend outside Asia **provided that it supports connectivity with Asia** or it is for a global public good and that the loan significantly benefits Asia. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
 - **The ceiling for non-regional loans is 25%.**
- The key sectors for the Bank are Energy, Transport, Water and Urban development.
- **About two-thirds of the loans** approved by the bank have been co-financed with other multilateral lending institutions, including the World Bank and the ADB.
- The triple-A ratings from Standard & Poor's, Moody's and Fitch, reflect the Bank's commitment to the highest standards of governance, enhanced transparency and accountability.

67. (c)

Explanation:

Rural Infra-Development Fund (RIDF)

- The Government of India created the **Rural Infrastructure Development Fund (RIDF)** in NABARD in 1995-96 by way of deposits from scheduled commercial banks operating within the country from the shortfall in their agricultural sector/priority sector/weaker section lending. The corpus of the fund has been extended on a year-to-year basis by GoI since then by provisions in the annual budget. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The fund was established in view that many States have neglected investment in infrastructure for agriculture and many rural infrastructure projects were left pending for want of funds.
- Such projects will assist states in completion of medium and minor irrigation, soil conservation, watershed management and other forms of rural infrastructure. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

68. (d)

Explanation:

- Every year, **April 22** is celebrated as Earth Day to raise public awareness about the environment and inspire people to save and protect it.
- The year 2021 marks the 51st anniversary of the annual celebrations. This year's theme for Earth Day is '**Restore Our Earth**'. **Hence, option (d) is correct.**
- In 2009, the United Nations designated April 22 as 'International Mother Earth Day'.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

22

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation

**69. (a)****Explanation:****Blue Chip Stocks:**

- Blue Chip Stocks refer to stocks of high value which give huge returns in the long run.
- They are shares of highly recognized and large companies which have a proven record of sound financial output and standing.
- These stocks are highly priced as they have tremendous goodwill as they are usually the market leaders in their industries.
- They are thus able to withstand tough market conditions and thereby give great returns. Oliver Gingold was the first to use this term in 1923.

Hence, option (a) is correct.

- Blue chip companies are recognised by many parameters like consistent revenue over a long period, debt to equity ratio, return on equity, price to earnings ratio etc.
 - Some of the blue chip companies in India are State Bank of India, Reliance Industries, Bharti Airtel, Tata Consultancy Services, Coal India, ONGC
 - ITC etc.

70. (a)**Explanation:****Unique Land Parcel Identification Number:**

- The Central Government is planning to issue a **14-digit identification number** to every plot of land in the country within a year. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- The **Unique Land Parcel Identification Number (ULPIN)** scheme has been launched in 10 States in the year 2021 and will be rolled out across the country by March 2022. **Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.**
- It is described as **“the Aadhaar for land”**, it is a number that would uniquely identify every surveyed parcel of land and prevent land fraud, especially in the hinterlands of rural India, where land records are outdated and often disputed.
- The identification will be based on the **longitude and latitude coordinates** of the land parcel and is dependent on detailed surveys and geo-referenced cadastral maps. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

71. (c)**Explanation:****International Civil Aviation Organisation**

- The Convention on International Civil Aviation, drafted in 1944 by 54 nations, was established to promote

cooperation and “create and preserve friendship and understanding among the nations and peoples of the world.”. It is known commonly as the ‘**Chicago Convention**’. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

- This landmark agreement laid the **foundation for the standards and procedures for peaceful global air navigation**. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- ICAO doesn’t approve world flight routes for international air traffic, it is instrumental to facilitating the cooperation and information needed to do so. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

72. (d)**Explanation:****Code on Wages Act, 2019:**

- The Code replaces the following four laws: (i) the Payment of Wages Act, 1936, (ii) the Minimum Wages Act, 1948, (iii) the Payment of Bonus Act, 1965, and (iv) the Equal Remuneration Act, 1976.
- **Coverage:** The Code will apply to all employees. The central government will make wage-related decisions for employments such as railways, mines, and oil fields, among others. State governments will make decisions for all other employments.
- Wages include salary, allowance, or any other component expressed in monetary terms. This does not include bonus payable to employees or any travelling allowance, among others.
- **Floor wage:** According to the Code, the central government will fix a floor wage, taking into account living standards of workers. Further, it **may set different floor wages for different geographical areas**. Before fixing the floor wage, the central government may obtain the advice of the Central Advisory Board and may consult with state governments. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- **Fixing the minimum wage:** The Code prohibits employers from paying wages less than the minimum wages. Minimum wages will be notified by the central or state governments. This will be based on time, or number of pieces produced. The minimum wages will be revised and reviewed by the central or state governments at an interval of not more than five years. While fixing minimum wages, the central or state governments may take into account factors such as: (i) skill of workers, and (ii) difficulty of work.

641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 11000921, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, PrayagrajPlot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur**23**Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- **Gender discrimination:** The Code prohibits gender discrimination in matters related to wages and recruitment of employees for the same work or work of similar nature. Work of similar nature is defined as work for which the skill, effort, experience, and responsibility required are the same. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

73. (a)

Explanation:

Civil Services Day:

- Every year, **21st April** is celebrated as **Civil Services Day** by the Government of India. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- It is celebrated as an occasion for the civil servants to rededicate themselves to the causes of citizens and renew their commitments to public service and excellence in work.
- **The date is chosen to commemorate the day when the first Home Minister of Independent India, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel addressed the probationers of Administrative Services Officers in 1947 at Metcalf House, Delhi.**
- On this day, the Prime Minister's Awards for Excellence in Public Administration are presented to Districts/Implementing Units for implementation of Priority programme and innovation categories. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**

74. (c)

Explanation:

- The Department of Agriculture & Cooperation is implementing a scheme namely, Market Intervention Scheme (MIS) for procurement of agricultural and horticultural commodities which are generally **perishable** in nature. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- The basic objective of MIS is to provide remunerative prices to the farmers in case of glut in production and fall in prices. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- Market Intervention Scheme (MIS) is also known as the invisible hand of agricultural marketing. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

75. (a)

Explanation:

Global Gender Gap Report 2021:

- It was first published in 2006 by the **World Economic Forum (WEF)**. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

- It benchmarks 156 countries on their progress towards gender parity in four dimensions:
 - **Economic Participation and Opportunity,**
 - **Educational Attainment,**
 - **Health and Survival and**
 - **Political Empowerment.**
- The highest possible score is **1 (equality)** and the lowest possible score is **0 (inequality).**
- **India is now one of the worst performers in South Asia, it is now ranked 140 among 156 countries. Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- **In South Asia, Bangladesh ranked 65, Nepal 106, Pakistan 153, Afghanistan 156, Bhutan 130, and Sri Lanka 116.**

Recent Report Updates:

- **Political Empowerment:**
 - India has **declined** on the political empowerment index by 13.5 percentage points, and a decline in the number of women ministers, from 23.1% in 2019 to 9.1% in 2021. However, it has still performed relatively well compared to other countries, ranking at 51 in women's participation in politics.
- **Education Attainment:**
 - In the index of education attainment, India has been ranked at 114.
- **Economic Participation:**
 - The report notes that the economic participation gender gap widened in India by 3% this year.
 - The estimated earned income of women in India is only one-fifth of men's, which puts the country among the bottom 10 globally on this indicator.
 - **Health and Survival index:** On this India has fared the worst, ranking at 155.

RIFT WIDENS

Highlights of report

▶ According to WEF's Global Gender Gap Report 2021, India has closed 62.5% of its gender gap till date ▶ India's gender gap on economic participation and opportunity sub-index widened by 3% this year ▶ Highest decline on political empowerment sub-index, where India regressed 13.5 percentage points ▶ Women's labour force participation rate fell from 24.8% to 22.3% ▶ Estimated earned income of women is only one-fifth	▶ of men's, which puts India among the bottom 10 ▶ India ranks among bottom five in discrimination against women in health and survival sub-index ▶ As Covid-19 impact continues to be felt, global gender gap has increased by a generation from 99.5 to 135.6 years ▶ Iceland is the most gender-equal nation for the 12th time in 15 years ▶ Top 10 gender-equal countries include Finland, Norway, New Zealand, Rwanda, Sweden, Ireland and Switzerland
--	---



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2 Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

24

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation

**76. (a)****Explanation:**

Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) celebrated its **92nd foundation day on 16th July 2020**.

- The Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) was **established on 16 July 1929** as a **registered society** under the **Societies Registration Act, 1860**. Hence, **statement 2 is NOT correct**.
- It is an **autonomous organisation** under the Department of Agricultural Research and Education (DARE), **Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare**, Government of India.
- It is **headquartered at New Delhi**. With 102 ICAR institutes and 71 agricultural universities spread across the country this is one of the largest national agricultural systems in the world.
- It is the **apex body** for coordinating, guiding and managing research and education in agriculture including horticulture, fisheries and animal sciences in the entire country.
- The ICAR has played a pioneering role in **ushering Green Revolution** and subsequent developments in agriculture in India through its research and technology development that has enabled the country to increase the **production of foodgrains by 5.6 times, horticultural crops by 10.5 times, fish by 16.8 times, milk by 10.4 times and eggs by 52.9 times since 1950-51 to 2017-18**.

Note:

- The Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) will start a **Farmers Innovation Fund**. Hence, **statement 1 is correct**.
- The **'Kisan Diwas' or National Farmers Day** is observed across the country on **23rd December** to celebrate the birth anniversary of **Chaudhary Charan Singh, the former Prime Minister of India**.

77. (a)**Explanation:**

The **World Bank, UN Women (a United Nations entity dedicated to gender equality and empowerment of women), and Small Industries Development Bank of India (SIDBI)** have come together to launch a five-year tenor women's livelihood bond (WLB).

- The proceeds from these social impact bonds will be used to help rural women in the country's poorest States to set up or scale up their own enterprises.

- WLB's will be **unsecured and unlisted**. Hence, **statement 2 is NOT correct**.
- The bonds will be placed with leading wealth managers and corporates in the country on a private placement basis.
- The return on these bonds will be **3% per annum**.
- SIDBI has also put together its own ₹1,000 crore social-impact fund 'Prayaas' for providing funding support to women entrepreneurs.
- The proposed bond will enable individual women entrepreneurs in sectors like food processing, agriculture, services, and small units to borrow around Rs 50,000 to Rs 3 lakh at an annual interest rate of around 13%-14% or less.
- **SIDBI acts as the financial intermediary** and channel funds raised to women entrepreneurs through participating financial intermediaries like banks, NBFCs or microfinance institutions. Hence, **statement 1 is correct**.

78. (d)**Explanation:****Navegaon-Nagzira Tiger Reserve (NNTR)**

- **Location:** It is situated in **Gondia and Bhandara districts of Maharashtra**.
 - Gondia District shares common boundaries with the state of **Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh** in the north and eastern side respectively. Hence, **statement 1 is NOT correct**.
 - Strategically, the Tiger Reserve is located in the heart of central Indian Tiger landscape which contributes almost one sixth of the total tiger population of the country.
- **Formation:** It was notified as to the **46th Tiger Reserve of India** in December 2013.
- NNTR comprised the notified area of Nawegaon National Park, Nawegaon Wildlife Sanctuary, Nagzira Wildlife Sanctuary, New Nagzira Wildlife Sanctuary and Koka Wildlife Sanctuary.
- **Flora:**
 - The major forest type is **"Southern Tropical Dry Deciduous Forest"**.
 - Few thorny plants are also found.
 - Bamboo occurs in abundance.
- **Fauna:**
 - Large Carnivores such as leopards and smaller carnivores like wild dogs, wolf jackals, jungle cats and also the good population of sloth bears are seen.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

25

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com



- The important herbivore includes Cheetal, Sambar, Nilgai, Chousingha, Barking deer, Wild pig and Indian gaur. Mouse deer have also been recorded from the area.
- More than 300 species of birds have been reported from the area.
- Tiger Reserves in Maharashtra and Year of Tiger Reserves notification:

Melghat	2007
Tadoba Andhari	2007
Pench – MH	2007
Sahyadri	2012
Bor	2012
Nawegaon Nagzira	2013

Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.

79. (a)

Explanation:

- **Compulsory Licensing (CL)** allows governments to license third parties (that is, parties other than the patent holders) to produce and market a patented product or process without the consent of patent owners.
- Compulsory Licensing is regulated under the **Indian Patent Act, 1970**. Hence, statement 1 is correct.
- **Compulsory Licensing is permitted under the WTO's Trade Related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS) Agreement** provided some conditions are fulfilled. Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.
- However, the agreement **does not specifically list** the reasons that might be used to justify compulsory licensing. But the **Doha Declaration** on TRIPS and Public Health confirms that **countries are free to determine the grounds** for granting compulsory licences, and to determine what constitutes a **national emergency**.

80. (b)

Explanation:

Project Dantak

- Recently, Project Dantak which is one of the oldest Projects of the **Border Roads Organisation (BRO)** commemorated its Diamond Jubilee in Bhutan.
- Project Dantak was established on 24th April 1961.
- It was a result of the visionary leadership of the third King of Bhutan and then Prime Minister of India Jawahar Lal Nehru.

- Dantak was tasked to construct the pioneering motorable roads in **Bhutan**. Hence, option (b) is correct.

81. (b)

Explanation:

- Recently, the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) approved a corpus of **Rs. 2,000 crore for Agri Market Infrastructure Fund (AMIF)** to be created with **NABARD** for development and upgradation of agricultural marketing infrastructure in rural agricultural markets. Hence, statement 2 is correct.
- The Agri-Market Infrastructure Fund was **announced in the 2018 Budget** for developing and upgrading agricultural marketing infrastructure in the **22,000 Gramin Agricultural Markets (GrAMs)** and **585 Agricultural Produce Market Committee (APMC)**. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.
- At present, GrAMs are being developed from the **MGNREGA fund**.
- The scheme being **demand-driven**, progress will depend on demand from states.

Objectives

- The fund will provide **subsidised loans to states and Union Territories** for 585 APMC mandis and 10,000 GrAMs.
- States can also utilise this fund for innovative integrated market infrastructure projects, including hub and spoke models and in private-public partnership mode.

NABARD

- National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development (NABARD) came into existence on the recommendation of B. Sivaraman Committee.
- It was approved by the Parliament through Act of 1981 and came into existence in 1982 by transferring the agricultural credit functions of RBI and refinance functions of the then Agricultural Refinance and Development Corporation (ARDC).
- **Functions of NABARD:**
 - NABARD gives high priority to projects formed under the **Integrated Rural Development Programme (IRDP)**.
 - It provides finance to **support poverty alleviation** programs run by IRDP.
 - It also makes the service area plan to provide backward and forward linkages and infrastructural support.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

26

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- It seeks to **establish linkages between Self-help Group (SHG)** that are organized by voluntary agencies for poor and needy in rural areas and other official credit agencies.
- It finances projects under the '**National Watershed Development Programme**' and the '**National Mission of Wasteland Development**'.
- It also **supervises the cooperative banks and Regional Rural Banks** to periodically ensure the development of the rural financing and farmers' welfare.

82. (a)

Explanation:

Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN)

- PM-KISAN is for the families of small and marginal farmers.
- Landless labourers are not covered under PM-KISAN.
- For the purpose of the calculation of the benefit, the Centre has defined a **small and marginal landholder family** as comprising of husband, wife and minor children up to 18 years of age, who collectively own cultivable land up to two hectares as per the land records of the concerned states. **Hence, option (a) is correct.**
- Income support under the scheme will be transferred directly into the bank accounts of beneficiary farmers, in three equal installments of Rs. 2,000 each.
- The complete expenditure for the scheme will be borne by the Union Government in 2019-20. Around 12 crore small and marginal farmer families are expected to benefit from this.

83. (c)

Explanation:

National Supercomputing Mission (NSM)

- **Launch:** NSM was announced in 2015, with an aim to connect national academic and research institutions with a grid of more than 70 high-performance computing facilities at an estimated cost of Rs. 4,500 crores over the period of seven years by 2022. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - It supports the government's vision of 'Digital India' and 'Make in India'.
- **Implementation:** NSM is jointly steered by the **Ministry of Electronics and IT (MeitY) and Department of**

Science and Technology (DST - Ministry of Science and Technology) and implemented by the **Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC)**, Pune and the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**

● **Features:**

- It is also an effort to improve the number of supercomputers owned by India. These supercomputers will also be networked on the National Supercomputing grid over the National Knowledge Network (NKN).
- The NKN connects academic institutions and R&D labs over a high-speed network.
- Under NSM, the long-term plan is to build a strong base of 20,000 skilled persons over the next five years who will be equipped to handle the complexities of supercomputers.

● **Progress of NSM:**

- In the first phase, PARAM Shivay, PARAM Shakti, PARAM Brahma, PARAM Yukti and PARAM Sanganak were deployed at IIT (BHU), IIT Kharagpur, Indian Institute of Science Education and Research, Pune, and Jawaharlal Nehru Centre for Advanced Research.
- Recently, PARAM-Siddhi AI has been ranked 63rd in the Top 500 list of most powerful supercomputers in the world. It was developed under the NSM.

84. (c)

Explanation:

- India is set to witness a sharp slowdown in population growth in the next two decades. Although the country as a whole will enjoy the "demographic dividend" phase, some states will start transitioning to an ageing society by 2030s. **Population in the 0-19 age bracket has already peaked** due to sharp declines in total fertility rates (TFR) across the country. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The southern states, Himachal Pradesh, Punjab, West Bengal and Maharashtra now have fertility rates well below the replacement rate. TFR in Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh are above the replacement rate but are also experiencing significant declines. As a result, the national TFR is expected to be below replacement level by 2021 (adjusted for the skewed gender ratio, it may already be there).



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

27

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- The age distribution, however, implies that India's working-age population will grow by roughly 9.7mn per year during 2021-31 and 4.2mn per year in 2031-41. Meanwhile, the proportion of elementary school-going children, i.e. 5-14 age group, will witness significant declines. Contrary to popular perception, many states need to pay greater attention to consolidating/merging schools to make them viable rather than building new ones.
- **TFR is now below replacement level fertility in 13 out of the 22 major states.** In fact, TFR has reached as low as 1.6-1.7 in states such as Delhi, West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Punjab and Himachal Pradesh. Even high fertility states such as Bihar, Jharkhand, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand have seen a sharp decline in TFR over the years. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**

85. (a)

Explanation:**National Commission for Minorities****Genesis:**

- In 1978, the setting up of the Minorities Commission (MC) was envisaged in the **Ministry of Home Affairs Resolution.**
- In 1992, with the enactment of the National Commission for Minorities (NCM) Act, 1992, the MC became a statutory body and was renamed as the NCM. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- In 1993, the first **Statutory National Commission was set up and five religious communities viz the Muslims, Christians, Sikhs, Buddhists and Zoroastrians (Parsis)** were notified as minority communities.
- In 2014, **Jains** were also notified as a minority community.

Composition:

- NCM consists of a **Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and five members** and all of them shall be from amongst the minority communities. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- A total of **7 persons to be nominated by the Central Government** should be from amongst persons of eminence, ability and integrity.
- **Tenure:** Each Member holds office for a period of **three years** from the date of assumption of office.

Functions:

- Evaluation of the **progress of the development** of minorities under the Union and States.
- Monitoring of the working of the **safeguards** for minorities provided in the Constitution and in laws enacted by Parliament and the state legislatures.
- **Making recommendations** for the effective implementation of **safeguards** for the protection of the interests of minorities by the central or state governments.
- **Looking into specific complaints** regarding deprivation of rights and safeguards of minorities and taking up such matters with the appropriate authorities.
- **Investigates** matters of communal conflict and riots.
- The Commission shall have all the powers of a civil court trying a suit. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**
- Observes the **Minorities Rights Day every year on 18th December** which marks the adoption of the "Declaration on the Rights of Persons belonging to National or Ethnic, Religious and Linguistic Minorities" by the United Nations in 1992.

86. (b)

Explanation:**Planetary-Pressure adjusted Human Development Index (PHDI)**

- The PHDI is the level of human development adjusted by **carbon dioxide emissions per person** (production-based) and **material footprint per capita to account for the excessive human pressure on the planet.** **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- It should be seen as an incentive for transformation. In an ideal scenario where there are no pressures on the planet, the PHDI equals the HDI. However, as pressures increase, the PHDI falls below the HDI. In this sense, the PHDI measures the level of human development when planetary pressures are considered.
- **Performance of the Countries:**
 - **Norway, which tops the HDI, falls 15 places** if this metric is used, leaving **Ireland at the top** of the table.
 - The **United States (HDI Rank -17) and Canada (HDI Rank -16) would fall 45 and 40 places** respectively, reflecting their disproportionate impact on natural resources.
 - The **oil and gas-rich Gulf States also fell steeply.** **China would drop 16 places** from its current ranking of 85.

641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 11000921, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, PrayagrajPlot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

28

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



● India's Performance:

- India would move up eight places in the HDI ranking. Hence, statement 2 is correct.
- Under the Paris Agreement, India pledged to reduce the emission intensity of its GDP from the 2005 level by 33-35% by 2030 and to obtain 40% of electric power capacity from non-fossil fuel sources by 2030.
 - ◆ Solar capacity in India increased from 2.6 gigawatts in March 2014 to 30 gigawatts in July 2019, achieving its target of 20 gigawatts four years ahead of schedule.
 - ◆ In 2019, India ranked fifth for installed solar capacity.
 - ◆ The National Solar Mission aims to promote solar energy for power generation and other uses to make solar energy competitive with fossil fuel-based options.

87. (c)

Explanation:

- **Amber box:** All subsidies which are supposed to distort production and trade fall into the amber box, i.e., all agricultural subsidies except those which fall into the blue and green boxes.
 - These include government policies of minimum support prices (as MSP in India) for agricultural products or any help directly related to production quantities (as power, fertilizers, pesticides, irrigation, etc).
- **Blue box:** This is the amber box with conditions. The conditions are designed to reduce distortions. Any subsidy that would normally be in the amber box, is placed in the blue box if it requires farmers to go for a certain production level.
 - These subsidies are nothing but certain direct payments (i.e. direct set-aside payments) made to farmers by the government in the form of assistance programmes to encourage agriculture, rural development, etc.
- **Green Box:** The agricultural subsidies which cause minimal or no distortions to trade are put under the green box. They must not involve price support.
 - This box basically includes all forms of government expenses, which are not targeted at a particular product, and all direct income support programmes to farmers, which are not related to current levels of production or prices.

- This is a very wide box and includes all government subsidies like – public storage for food security, pest and disease control, research and extension, and some direct payments to farmers that do not stimulate production like restructuring of agriculture, environmental protection, regional development, crop and income insurance, etc.

- The green box subsidies are allowed without limits provided they comply with the policy- specific criteria. It means, this box is exempt from the calculation under subsidies under the WTO provisions because the subsidies under it are not meant to promote production and thus do not distort trade. That is why this box is called 'Production-Neutral Box'. Hence, option (c) is correct.

88. (b)

Explanation:

Aahaar Kranti Mission

- The 'Aahaar Kranti' movement is designed to address the particular problem being faced by India and the world- 'hunger and diseases in abundance'.
- Studies have estimated that India produces as much as two times the amount of calories it consumes. However, many in the country are still malnourished. The root cause of this strange phenomenon is a lack of nutritional awareness. Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.
- The initiative will shine a light on the richness and value of India's traditional diet, the miracles of local fruits and vegetables, and the healing powers of a balanced diet. Hence, statement 2 is correct.
- **Organisations Involved:** Pravasi Bharatiya Academic and Scientific Sampark (PRABHASS), Global Indian Scientists and Technocrats' Forum (GIST), Vijnana Bharati (Vibha) and Vigyan Prasar (an autonomous body of the Department of Science and Technology) have come together to launch the mission 'Aahaar Kranti'.
- The motto of the Mission is "Uttam Aahaar- Uttam Vichaar or Good Diet-Good Cognition".

89. (b)

Explanation:

Mission Karmayogi

- **Aim & Objective:**
 - It is aimed at building a future-ready civil service with the right attitude, skills and knowledge, aligned to the vision of New India.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

29

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- It aims to prepare Indian civil servants for the future by making them more creative, constructive, imaginative, proactive, innovative, progressive, professional, energetic, transparent, and technology-enabled.
- Comprehensive reform of the capacity building apparatus at the individual, institutional and process levels for efficient public service delivery.
- **Features of the scheme:**
 - **Tech-Aided:** The capacity building will be delivered through iGOT Karmayogi digital platform, with content drawn from global best practices.
 - The platform will act as a launchpad for the National Programme for Civil Services Capacity Building (NPCSCB).
 - **Coverage:** The scheme will cover 46 lakh, central government employees, at all levels. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
 - **Shift from Rules to Roles:** The programme will support a transition from “rules-based to roles-based” Human Resource Management (HRM) so that work allocations can be done by matching an official’s competencies to the requirements of the post.
 - Apart from domain knowledge training, the scheme will focus on “functional and behavioural competencies” as well, and also includes a monitoring framework for performance evaluations.
- **Governance Structure:**
 - **Human Resource Council:** NPCSCB will be governed by the **Prime Minister’s Human Resource Council**, which will also include state Chief Ministers, Union Cabinet ministers, and experts. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- This council will approve and review civil service capacity building programmes.
- **Cabinet Secretary Coordination Unit:** There will be a Cabinet Secretary Coordination Unit comprising select secretaries and cadre controlling authorities.
- **Capacity Building Commission:** Also, there will be a Capacity Building Commission, which will include experts in related fields and global professionals.
- **Special Purpose Vehicle:** Finally, there will be a wholly-owned Special Purpose Vehicle (SPV), which will govern the iGOT-Karmayogi platform.

- **It will be set up under Section 8 of the Companies Act, 2013.**
- The SPV will be a “not-for-profit” company and will own and manage the iGOT-Karmayogi platform.
- The SPV will create and operationalize the content, market place and manage key business services of the iGOT-Karmayogi platform, relating to content validation, independent proctored assessments and telemetry data availability.
- The SPV will own all Intellectual Property Rights on behalf of the Government of India.
- **Monitoring and Evaluation Framework:** An appropriate monitoring and evaluation framework will also be put in place for performance evaluation of all users of the iGOT-Karmayogi platform so as to generate a dashboard view of Key Performance Indicators.

90. (d)

Explanation:

Indian Rhino Vision 2020:

- Launched in 2005, the Indian Rhino Vision 2020 was an ambitious effort to attain a **wild population of at least 3,000** greater one-horned rhinos spread over **seven protected areas in the Indian state of Assam by the year 2020**. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**
- The Indian Rhino Vision 2020 (IRV2020) has **officially come to a close** with the translocation of two rhinos in April 2021 to Manas National Park in Assam, India. **Hence, statement 2 is NOT correct.**
- Seven protected areas are **Kaziranga, Pobitora, Orang National Park, Manas National Park, Laokhowa wildlife sanctuary, Burachapori wildlife sanctuary** and Dibru Saikhowa wildlife sanctuary.
- Wild-to-wild translocations were an essential part of IRV2020 – moving rhinos from densely populated parks like Kaziranga NP to ones in need of more rhinos, like Manas NP.
- It is a collaborative effort between various organisations, including the **International Rhino Foundation, Assam’s Forest Department, Bodoland Territorial Council, World Wide Fund - India, and the US Fish and Wildlife Service.**

Performance of the Program:

- The target of attaining a population of 3,000 rhinos almost achieved.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

30

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- The translocated rhinos helped Manas National Park get back its World Heritage Site status in 2011.
- 2018 and 2019 saw significant decreases in poaching, the results of forestry, local and national government officials coordinating efforts to combat wildlife crime across Assam.

About Greater One-Horned Rhino:

- There are three species of rhino in Asia — Greater one-horned (*Rhinoceros unicornis*), Javan and Sumatran.
- Poaching for the horns and habitat loss are the two greatest threats to the survival of Asia's rhinos.
- The five rhino range nations (India, Bhutan, Nepal, Indonesia and Malaysia) have signed a declaration 'The New Delhi Declaration on Asian Rhinos 2019' for the conservation and protection of the species.
- **Protection Status: Javan and Sumatran Rhino are critically endangered and the Greater one-horned (or Indian) rhino is vulnerable** under the IUCN Red List.
- All three listed under Appendix I (CITES).
- Greater one-horned rhino is listed under **Schedule I of the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972.**

91. (d)

Explanation:

- The **Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), General Insurance Corporation of India and The New India Assurance Co Ltd** have been identified as **Domestic Systemically Important Insurers (D-SIIs)** for 2020-21 by insurance regulator, the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI). **Hence, option (d) is correct.**
- The three public sector insurers have been asked to raise the level of corporate governance.
- Identify all relevant risks and promote a sound risk management culture.
- The D-SIIs will also be subjected to enhanced regulatory supervision of the IRDAI.

92. (b)

Explanation:

Kisan Credit Card:

- The Kisan Credit Card (KCC) scheme was introduced in **1998** for providing **adequate and timely credit support** from the banking system under a single window with the flexible and simplified procedure to the farmers for their

cultivation and other needs like the purchase of agriculture inputs such as seeds, fertilizers, pesticides, etc. and draw cash for their production needs.

- The scheme was further extended for the **investment credit requirement of farmers** viz. allied and non-farm activities in the year 2004.
- KCC covers **post-harvest expenses, produce marketing loan, consumption requirements of farmer household, working capital for maintenance of farm assets and activities allied to agriculture, investment credit requirement for agriculture and allied activities. Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The Kisan Credit Card Scheme is implemented by Commercial Banks, RRBs, Small Finance Banks, and Cooperatives. **Hence, statement 1 is NOT correct.**

93. (c)

Explanation:

- Hedging is a financial technique that helps to reduce or mitigate the effects of measurable type of risk from the future changes in the fair value. **Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
- It is a kind of insurance that does not eliminate the risk completely but mitigates its effect. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- The Reserve Bank relaxed norms for external commercial borrowings (ECBs) by reducing the mandatory hedging provision to 70% from the current 100%.
- After the global financial crisis, the RBI mandated 100% hedging for medium-term external borrowings.

94. (b)

Explanation:

Poshan Abhiyaan:

- The **National Council on India's Nutrition Challenges-** Set up **under the Poshan Abhiyaan**, the Council is also known as National Council on Nutrition (NCN). The NCN is headed by the Vice-Chairman of the NITI Aayog.
- **Poshan Abhiyaan** targets to reduce stunting, **undernutrition, anaemia (among young children, women and adolescent girls)** and reduce low birth weight by 2%, 2%, 3% and 2% per annum respectively.
- The target of the mission is to bring down stunting among children in the age group 0-6 years from 38.4% to 25% by 2022.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

31

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- **Swasth Bharat Preraks** will be deployed one in each district for coordinating with district officials and enabling fast and efficient execution of the Abhiyan across the country. Swasth Bharat Preraks would function as catalyst for fast tracking the implementation of the Abhiyan. Hence, option (b) is correct.

95. (c)

Explanation:

mRNA Vaccine vs Traditional Vaccines:

- Vaccines work by training the body to recognise and respond to the proteins produced by disease-causing organisms, such as a virus or bacteria.
- Traditional vaccines are made **up of small or inactivated doses of the whole disease-causing organism**, or the proteins that it produces, which are introduced into the body to provoke the immune system into mounting a response.
- mRNA vaccines have no disease-causing organism, it trick the body into **producing some of the viral proteins** themselves. Hence, statement 1 is correct.
- They work by using mRNA, or messenger RNA, which is the molecule that essentially puts DNA instructions into action. Inside a cell, mRNA is used as a template to build a protein.

Functioning of mRNA Vaccines:

- To produce an mRNA vaccine, scientists produce a **synthetic version of the mRNA that a virus uses to build its infectious proteins**.
- This **mRNA is delivered into the human body**, whose cells read it as instructions to build that viral protein and therefore create some of the virus's molecules themselves.
- These **proteins are solitary, so they do not assemble to form a virus**. The immune system then detects these viral proteins and starts to produce a defensive response to them.

Advantages of Using mRNA based Vaccines:

- mRNA vaccines are **considered safe as mRNA is non-infectious, non-integrating in nature**, and degraded by standard cellular mechanisms. Hence, statement 2 is correct.
- They are **highly efficacious** because of their inherent capability of being translatable into the protein structure inside the cell cytoplasm.
- Additionally, **mRNA vaccines are fully synthetic** and do not require a host for growth, e.g., eggs or bacteria.

Therefore, they can be quickly manufactured inexpensively to ensure their “availability” and “accessibility” for mass vaccination on a sustainable basis.

Mission Covid Suraksha

- Mission Covid Suraksha is India's targeted effort to enable the **development of indigenous, affordable and accessible vaccines** for the country.
- The Mission with its end-to-end focus from preclinical development through clinical development and manufacturing and regulatory facilitation for deployment consolidate all available and funded resources towards accelerated product development.
- It is led by the **Department of Biotechnology and implemented by a dedicated Mission Implementation Unit at Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC)**.

BIRAC

- Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC) is a **not-for-profit Public Sector Enterprise**.
- It has been set up by the Department of Biotechnology (DBT) as an Interface Agency to strengthen and empower the emerging Biotech enterprise to undertake strategic research and innovation, addressing nationally relevant product development needs.

96. (d)

Explanation:

Animal Husbandry:

- Animal Husbandry is an integral part of the farming system in the Himalaya in general, and upper Rangit Basin in particular.
- It plays an important role in the **food chain**.
- As agriculture, horticulture and agroforestry form a major component of farming system, livestock rearing system is to support the main component.
- They help to recycle the **crop residues and agricultural products effectively**. Hence, statement 1 is correct.
- The livestock are utilised as chief media of **disposal of crop residues** and agricultural by products.
- The animals under this system thus have a **multi-functional utility and their products such as milk, meat and eggs are by and large utilised domestically** and surplus if any is sold in the neighbourhood or in the nearby market.
- India is **number one milk producer** in the world.



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

32

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



- It provides employment to about **8.8% of the population** in India. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
- About 20.5 million people depend upon livestock for their livelihood.
- Livestock contributed **16%** to the income of small farm households as against an average of 14% for all rural households.
- Livestock provides livelihood to **two-third** of rural communities.
- It also provides employment to about 8.8% of the population in India.
- India has vast livestock resources.
- Livestock sector contributes 4.11% GDP and 25.6% of total Agriculture GDP. **Hence, statement 3 is correct.**

97. (c)**Explanation:****Atal Bimit Vyakti Kalyan Yojana: ESIC**

- Atal Bimit Vyakti Kalyan Yojana was introduced w.e.f. 1st July 2018.
- Under it, unemployment benefit is paid to the workers covered under the Employees' State Insurance (ESI) scheme. **Hence, option (c) is correct.**
- Unemployment benefit is paid in the form of cash compensation upto 90 days, once in a lifetime, to be claimed after three months (90 days) in one or more spells for being rendered unemployed.
 - The employee should have completed two years of insurable employment and has contributed not less than 78 days in each of the four consecutive contribution periods immediately preceding to the claim of the relief.
- The benefit does not exceed 25% of the average earning per day.

About the ESI Act, 1948:

- It applies to all factories and notified establishments located in implemented areas employing 10 or more persons and is applicable on employees drawing wages up to Rs. 21,000 per month (Rs. 25,000 for persons with disabilities).
- In July 2019, the contribution rate under the ESI Act was reduced from 6.5% to 4% (employers' contribution from 4.75% to 3.25% and employees' contribution from 1.75% to 0.75%).
 - In a financial year, there are two contribution periods each of six months duration.

- Employees in receipt of a daily average wage upto Rs.137 are exempted from payment of contribution.
- The Employees' State Insurance Scheme is administered by a corporate body called the ESI Corporation.
 - The Corporation is the highest policy-making and decision-taking authority under the ESI Act and oversees the functioning of the Scheme.
 - The Union Minister of Labour and Employment is its Chairman.
- It covers about 3.49 crore of family units of workers and provides cash benefits and medical facilities to 13.56 crore beneficiaries.

98. (c)**Explanation:****National Internet Exchange of India (NIXI):**

- NIXI is a **not-for-profit organization** (section 8 of the Companies Act 2013) working since 2003 for spreading the internet infrastructure to the citizens of India through the following activities:
 - Internet Exchanges through which the **internet data is exchanged amongst Internet Service Providers (ISP's), Data Centers and Content Delivery Network (CDNs). Hence, statement 1 is correct.**
 - .IN Registry, managing and operation of .IN country-code domain and .BHARAT IDN (Internationalized Domain Name) domain for India. **Hence, statement 2 is correct.**
 - Indian Registry for Internet Names and Numbers (IRINN), managing and operating Internet Protocol (IPv4/IPv6).
 - **About the Three New Initiatives:**
 - **IPv6 Expert Panel (IP Guru):**
 - ◆ It is a **group to extend support to all the Indian entities** who are finding it technically challenging to migrate and adopt IPv6. It will be **offering its services free of cost.**
 - ◆ It's a joint effort of the Department of Telecom (DOT), MeitY and industry.
 - **NIXI Academy:**
 - NIXI Academy is created **to educate technical/non-technical people** in India to learn and relearn technologies like IPv6 which are normally not taught in Educational Institutes.
 - Successful candidates (after passing the examination) **can take a certificate from NIXI**, which will be useful to find/upgrade jobs in the Industry.

641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 11000921, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, PrayagrajPlot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur**33**Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation



● **NIXI-IP-INDEX:**

- NIXI has developed an **IPv6 index portal** for the Internet community.
- NIXI-IP-INDEX portal will **showcase the IPv6 adoption rate in India and across the world**. It can be used to compare the IPv6 Indian adoption rate with other economies in the world.
- It will also include **details about web adoption in IPv6, IPv6 traffic etc.**

99. (b)

Explanation:

- In a multi cropping system, farmers grow **two or more crops on farmland in one calendar year** (unlike mono-cropping, that involves planting only one crop on a field). It includes **inter-cropping, mixed-cropping and relay cropping**. Hence, statements 1 and 2 are correct.
- Intercropping is growing **two or more crops simultaneously in a definite cropping pattern**. Mixed intercropping involves growing more than one crop simultaneously without any distinct row arrangement. Hence, statement 3 is NOT correct.

100. (d)

Explanation:

- Recently, the **United Nations Population Fund's** flagship **State of World Population Report 2021** titled '**My Body is My Own**' was launched. Hence, option (d) is correct.
- **Violation of Bodily Autonomy:**
 - The principle of bodily integrity sums up the **right of each human being, including children, to autonomy and self-determination** over their own body. It considers an unconsented physical intrusion as a human rights violation.

● **Some Examples:**

- Child marriage.
- Female genital mutilation.
- Lack of contraceptive choices leading to an unplanned pregnancy.
- Unwanted sex exchanged for a home and food.
- When people with diverse sexual orientations and gender identities cannot walk down a street without fearing assault or humiliation.

United Nations Population Fund

● **About:**

- It is a subsidiary organ of the **UN General Assembly** and works as a sexual and reproductive health agency.
- The **UN Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC)** establishes its mandate.

● **Establishment:**

- It was established as a trust fund in 1967 and began operations in 1969.
- In **1987, it was officially renamed the United Nations Population Fund** but the original abbreviation, 'UNFPA' for the United Nations Fund for Population Activities was retained.

● **Objective:**

- UNFPA works directly to tackle **Sustainable Development Goals** on health (SDG3), education (SDG4) and gender equality (SDG5).

● **Fund:**

- UNFPA is not **supported by the UN budget, instead, it is entirely supported by voluntary contributions of donor governments, intergovernmental organizations, the private sector, foundations and individuals.**



641, 1st floor, Mukherjee
Nagar, Delhi 110009

21, Pusa Road,
Karol Bagh, New Delhi

13/15, Tashkent Marg, Near
Patrika Chauraha, Civil Lines, Prayagraj

Plot No. 45-45A, Harsh Tower 2
Tonk Rd, Vasundhara Colony, Jaipur

34

Phone : 8448485518, 011-47532596, 8750187501 :: www.drishtiIAS.com

Copyright – Drishti The Vision Foundation